

George Douglas Papers annotated transcription

Volume VIII

Folder 7 poems and other writings

Version 2.0

September 2026

Prepared for Volney Douglas

From scans supplied by Abilene Christian University

Special Collections and Archives

Original wording where readable, with source locators, marked uncertainty and editorial notes.

This volume accounts for all 133 scan pages of source 10. It belongs to a set covering 932 scan pages in ten source PDFs. This AI-assisted contribution is offered for review and correction.

Reading this volume

Preparation and independence

Prepared for Volney Douglas with AI assistance in September 2026. Every new scan page received an initial visual reading, with selected enlargement, rotation, contrast adjustment and comparison against related passages within the source collection. Local Apple Vision OCR was run at four orientations on all 545 new pages as a reading aid. OCR agreement alone did not establish a reading. The other agent's transcription was excluded as a source for this addition. Reference and family readings of the new pages were prepared together from the scans; they are not independent of each other. No independent human verification or ACU endorsement is claimed. The earlier version 1.1 has its own disclosed comparison history, preserved in the previous guide and review records.

Reference and family editions

The annotated reference edition preserves readable original wording, spelling, grammar and abbreviations. Ordinary prose wrapping may be reflowed; poem lines and ledger groups are retained. Capitalization, punctuation and word division sometimes require judgment. Superscripts are generally lowered; raised numbers in the convivial journal are retained. Underlining and decorative marks are not systematically encoded. This is a direct reading transcript, not a facsimile or fully diplomatic edition. The family edition modernizes wording and explains abbreviated forms where secure. Very damaged passages sometimes receive an explicitly identified fragmentary reading rather than an invented continuous text. Financial figures remain as read and are not silently reconciled.

Uncertainty and interventions

Double square brackets identify editorial intervention. `[[word?]]` is a tentative reading; `[[illegible]]` marks unread writing, with no implied word count. `[[lost: description]]` records missing material and `[[obscured: description]]` records an obstruction. `[[deleted: text]]` and `[[inserted: text]]` distinguish readable revisions. `[[separate block: description]]`, `[[blank]]` and other descriptive markers explain layout or non-textual material. Original single brackets and question marks remain part of the source. A gap is not filled solely to make a fluent sentence or to match a related copy.

Order and evidence

The reference volumes retain PDF scan order. Editorial notes link displaced continuations and clearer related versions. The family edition also retains source-page locators, with reading-order guidance beside the relevant text. Later identifying slips remain distinct from the manuscript and may disagree with it. A name in an account does not establish kinship, ownership or parentage. Poems may use fictional speakers, aliases, satire and imagined events. Letters preserve their writers' assertions, rumors and opinions, including offensive historical language; a transcript does not verify those statements.

Locators and corrections

A page ID such as 09-003 means source 09, PDF scan page 3, counting the cover as page 1. A block ID such as 09-003-P02 identifies the second transcript block. These locators are not original manuscript page numbers. Earlier IDs are unchanged. New uncertainty IDs append U001, U002 and so on to their source-page ID. Please propose corrections with the locator, existing wording, proposed wording and supporting image evidence. The original scans remain authoritative.

Source credit

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Source record

George Douglas Papers Folder 7 - Poems Etc.pdf

SHA-256: 3cda436be7bee32202e7103029824d0252d162d88303988be716c2f558dcf4a2

Scan 001 10-001

Repository cover: Folder 7, Poems, Etc.

10-001-P01 Abilene Christian University

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1860

George Douglas Papers Folder 7 - Poems, Etc

Douglas

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Editorial note. This is the repository-generated cover, not an original manuscript page. The displayed date 1860 is catalog metadata and does not date every item in the folder. The following ledger includes entries dated 1872 and 1873.

Scan 002 10-002

Lumber ledger: inside cover and index A–E

10-002-P01 *[[separate block: inside cover]]*

[[illegible: faint pencil words]]

Lumber for own use

Page 22,

40 *[[illegible: faint figures and words]]*

[[separate block: ledger index, page 1]]

A

B. Bledsoe Jno 21

Birkhead L 25

C. *[[Crumtee?]]* 11

Cannon 12

Cash Sales 7

[[Dowdy?]] 17

Dunn 20

Ellis & White 87

Ellis 16

Editorial note. Names here are account-index entries, not proof of kinship. Page numbers refer to the ledger's handwritten numbering, not PDF scan pages. Several names require comparison with the full account headings later in the volume. Faint inside-cover writing remains unresolved.

Scan 003 10-003

Account index F–O, calculations, and a medicinal note

10-003-P01 *[[separate block: index page 2]]*

F. *[[blank]]*

G. Gibson J G 8

Goodloe 25

H. Hatter 13

[[separate block: pencil calculation]]

74 4957

65 4802

65 *[[4492?]]*

[[208?]] 14251

113 *[[80?]]*

28 *[[71?]]*

[[separate block: index page 3 and notes]]

[[Riley?]] Chas 19

[[illegible: two faint lines, including “No 30” and “No 12”]]

M. Morris 14

Moffet 11

Lactophytin

5 gr before each meal

[[after?]]

O. Odom 9

Editorial note. Pencil notes are separate from the account index. The apparent medicinal note is a historical transcription, not a treatment recommendation. Its term “Lactophytin” is preserved as written/read; no modern drug identification is supplied. Numbers in the scratch calculation are not reconciled or silently corrected.

Scan 004 10-004

Account index P–W

10-004-P01 *[[separate block: index page 4]]*

P Page

Payne 6

[[Partee?]] James 18

Porter geo 50

R. Renfroe 10

Rawlins Milton 20

Robinson 90–91

S. Stevenson 15

Sweatt 26

Samuel Lee 29

[[separate block: index page 5]]

W Page

Winniford 10

Winniford C. 27

Editorial note. Numbers are references to handwritten ledger pages. “Partee” is tentative. The entry “Samuel Lee” is retained in its written order, even though placed under S. No family relationship is inferred from an account entry.

Scan 005 10-005

Payne's fencing order and cash lumber sales, January 13, 1872

10-005-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 6]]*

Jan 13 1872

Paynes Acct

700 ft fencing Engaged

Credit by Cash 10 00

Feby *[[1873?]]*

[[Credit boards?]] 75 *[[illegible]]* 7 50

Filled in full

[[separate block: ledger page 7]]

Jan 13 1872

Sold

96 ft Sheeting Cash 1 40

600 ft C. f. 15 00

108 ft Scantling " 2 70

64 ft C. f. " 1 55

179 ft Sheeting " 2 69

Editorial note. Amounts are shown with the source's separated dollar/cents notation, without recalculation. "C. f." is not expanded before comparison with subsequent accounts. The February credit and its year are faint. "Filled in full" is the source wording and does not necessarily mean paid in full.

Scan 006 10-006

Gibson and Odom lumber accounts, 1872–1873

10-006-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 8]]*

J. J. Gibson

Jan 9. 1872

570 ft c. f. Old Book

Credit by 12 00

Feby — 1873

Sold to *[[Coleman?]]*

for Gibson by *[[Tom?]]*

300 ft c. f.

Credit by 7 50

[[separate block: ledger page 9]]

Odom

Jan 9. 1873

300 ft c. f. Cash 7 50

Editorial note. The account heading appears to read J. J. Gibson; the index on 10-003 appears to give J. G. Gibson. The discrepancy is retained. "Old Book" appears to refer to an earlier account book. The February buyer and intermediary remain uncertain.

Scan 007 10-007

Renfroe, Winniford, and [[Crumpton?]] lumber entries; Moffet's purchases

10-007-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 10]]*

Renfroe Dr Cr

Jan 9. 1873

150 ft c. f. 3 75

Credit by 1 50

Winniford

July 1873

185 ft c. Boxing 4 62

[[separate block: ledger page 11]]

[[Crumpton?]] Dr

Jan 8 1873

892 ft Cottonwood 22 30

Credit by Cash 22 30

Moffet Acct

1 *[[lot?]]* *[[illegible]]* 1 00

4 yds Linen 25 1 00

1 pr Gloves 50

1 " Blk Hose 35

1 Corset 1 00

12 yds Checks 35 4 20

10 " Calico 1 25

36¾

Editorial note. A large stroke runs through the cottonwood account, apparently marking the account rather than deleting individual words. The name remains tentative. "36¾" is an isolated figure below Moffet's entries, not identified as a total. The first Moffet item is not securely readable.

Scan 008 10-008

Cannon and Hatter accounts; a small land sketch and arithmetic

10-008-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 12]]*

Cannon Dr

Jan 10. 1873

[[837?]] c. f. by Book 20 90

Credit by cash 20 90

Jan 11 1873

600 ft c. f. 15 00

Credit by cash 15 00

[[separate block: ledger page 13]]

Hatter Dr Cr

Jan 10. 1873

102 ft c. f. 2 55

Credit by cash 2 55

[[separate block: inverted sketch and calculations on page 12]]

268

25

Plat for 15

acres in S E C

of W. J. *[[illegible]]*

975

2685

3330

2352

[[915?]]

1377

578

799

[[1100?]]

[[626?]]

1084

775

309

[[separate block: inverted calculation on page 13]]

25

775 1700

309 626

1084 1074

626

1710

Editorial note. The quantity in Cannon's first entry is uncertain and has not been adjusted to make the charge work mathematically. The inverted material includes a small four-sided plat with dimensions, a reference to 15 acres, and scratch calculations. The abbreviated location and name do not establish an identified property. The spatial arithmetic is transcribed in groups without claiming reconciliation.

Scan 009 10-009

Morris and Stevenson accounts; faint pencilled additions

10-009-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 14]]*

Dr Morris Dr Cr

Jan 10. 1873

288 ft Sheeting 4 32

Placed to mill acct

[[separate block: ledger page 15]]

Jan *[[14?]]* 1873

Sold J Stevenson

[[Oak?]] Herring

2 ft at 3.00 *[[06?]]*

[[deleted: faint words]]

5 *[[Oak?]]* *[[illegible]]*

[[separate block: inverted pencilled words and figures on page 15]]

12 Yds Checks 30 3 60
 18 " Calico *[[illegible]]*
 4 " *[[Lawn?]]* *[[illegible]]*
 1 " *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: overlapping calculations]]
[[separate block: inverted faint verse or lines on page 14]]
[[illegible: first two lines]]
 And *[[illegible]]*
 Each *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] hills *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: several lines]]
[[illegible]] at the *[[illegible]]*
 O *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]]
[[A Morrow?]] *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The inverted pencil writing is actual separate writing, not merely show-through. Most of those lines and the overlapping calculations remain unreadable; this is a partial transcription, not a recovered poem. The apparent name at the end is tentative and is not an attribution of authorship. Morris's payment annotation reads "Placed to mill acct." Stevenson's date, wood description, and small amount remain uncertain.

Scan 010 10-010

Polk Ellis and Dowdy lumber accounts, 1873

10-010-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 16]]*
 Polk Ellis
 Feby 27 1873
 220 ft Sheeting
 Credit by 5 00
[[separate block: ledger page 17]]
 Dowdy Acct Dr Cr
 Jan 15 1873
 300 ft Fencing 7 50
 Jan *[[blank]]* 1873
 132 ft Sct 3 30
 Placed to mill a/c

Editorial note. The date of Dowdy's second January entry is left blank in the source. "Sct" is retained in the reference transcript and tentatively expanded as scantling in the family reading. The transfer annotation reads "Placed to mill a/c," as in adjacent accounts.

Scan 011 10-011

Lumber accounts and an invitation in verse

10-011-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 18]]*
 James *[[Parr?]]* Dr Cr
 Jan 23 1873
 304 ft c. Boxing 7.60
 Placed to mill account

[[separate block: pencilled verse below the account]]

Why dont you come ye gentle fair
 The days pass slowly by
 My heart oppressed with anxious *[[inserted: care]]*
 How slow the moments fly
 Your pleasant smiles and *[[winning?]]* ways
 Would sure the gloom dispell
[[For e'en?]] the fire would brighter *[[inserted: blaze]]*
 The *[[now world scouted?]]* smile
 Then come and grace our *[[inserted: social board]]*
 Our fireside joys to share
 We'll give a cordial welcome *[[glad?]]*
 A lone *[[illegible]]* will to *[[illegible]]*
[[separate block: ledger page 19]]
 Charles *[[Riley?]]* Dr Cr
 Jan 22. 1873
 302 ft Sheeting 4 53
 Placed to mill acct

Editorial note. The left account surname is not secure; the index on 10-004 tentatively reads Partee. The poem is an untitled draft with inserted alternatives. Some wording, especially the eighth and last lines, remains unresolved. No author or addressee is identified. The ledger's date does not necessarily date the pencilled verse.

Scan 012 10-012

A lumber donation to the church at Hutchins; Dunn and Bledsoe accounts

10-012-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 20]]*

Milton Rawlins Dr Cr

Feby 28 1873

Donated to Church

at Hutchins by

M. Rawlins

300 ft Sheeting

Dunn, Tom

March 22. 1873

175 ft c. f. 4 35

[[separate block: ledger page 21]]

John Bledsoe Dr Cr

March 26

1873

2000 ft c. f. Per

Schneider 50.00

Placed to mill acct

Editorial note. The donation is explicitly attributed to M. Rawlins, not to the ledger's owner. Dunn's written charge is retained without adjustment. "Per Schneider" appears in Bledsoe's entry and does not identify a family relationship.

Scan 013 10-013

Lumber for own use and entries since settlement, 1873

10-013-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 22, lumber for own use]]*

115 Jan 25 1873

240 March 5 c f

466 " 14 "

410 " 15 "

500 " 17 "

600 " 18 "

476 " 20 "

500 " 21 "

458 " 22 "

460 " 27 "

400 " 28 "

500 " 29 "

550 " 31 "

500 April 1st "

550 " 3 "

[[separate block: ledger page 23]]

Since Settlement

500 c f May 10 1873

578 Scantling July 11 1873

566 " " 23 "

482 Sycamore Aug 6 "

750 c f " 9

350 C Boxing " 13

3229

185 *[[illegible]]*

3314

350 Ash flooring Oct 15

[[separate block: outlined calculation]]

March 10 1873

600 feet *[[illegible]]* fencing

[[Dressed?]] *[[illegible]]*

450 *[[illegible]]*

650 ft c fence between Red Oak

1600 Half due mill

[[5 600?]]

Editorial note. The inside-cover index explicitly calls page 22 "Lumber for own use." The owner is not named on this spread. Ditto marks continue the source's abbreviated material column. The page 23 figures, totals, and outlined calculation do not all reconcile clearly; they are retained as read. Several pencil entries require a better image.

Scan 014 10-014

Birkhead and R. H. Goodloe accounts, March 1873

10-014-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 24]]*

[[blank]]

[[separate block: ledger page 25]]

Birkhead Dr Cr

March 21. 1873

2000 ft c. f.

Credit by Cash 50.00

[[separate block: pencil calculation]]

32 40.14

22.50

62.64

[[separate block: second account]]

Goodloe R. H.

March 22 1873

1000 ft c. f. 25 00

Credit by cash 24 50

March 29 1873

Credit by cash 50

Editorial note. Page 24 contains no substantive entry. The scratch figure "32" sits separately beside the 40.14/22.50/62.64 calculation and is not assigned to an account. Goodloe's two credits are reproduced separately.

Scan 015 10-015

Bell, Sweatt, Samuel Lee, and Ephriam Winniford accounts

10-015-P01 *[[separate block: ledger page 26]]*

J. W. Bell Dr Cr

March 31 1873

[[illegible]] ft c f

200 ft c f *[[4 55?]]* 6.00

185 *[[illegible]]* c f

2182

[[separate block: calculation beside Bell's entry]]

759

71

830

[[separate block: further accounts]]

D. J. Sweatt

200 ft c f 5.00

Samuel Lee

92 ft Strips 2 32

Credit by Cash 1 36

[[separate block: scratch calculation]]

92

2

184

[[49?]]

2.33

[[separate block: ledger page 27]]

Ephriam Winniford

Worked 13 days *[[Aug?]]* 15

March 28 1874

April 29 1874

Paid E Winniford

\$ 8.30

Due 9.00

Paid by Note

Sept 12 1874

Editorial note. Bell's account is crossed by large strokes and contains faint or overwritten figures; no single corrected balance is imposed. "Ephriam" follows the apparent spelling of the heading. The placement of the work-period notation beside dates is ambiguous; the dated payments and note are transcribed independently. The isolated arithmetic is not silently reconciled with the account.

Scan 016 10-016

Faint verse draft on youth, affection, and passing time

10-016-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 28, verse draft]]*

Sweet *[[Birds?]]* *[[illegible]]* thy own sunny woodlands

[[illegible: line with inserted words]]

Where *[[illegible]]* crowned by *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] wide *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] your love *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] the *[[inventive?]]* *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: line with interlineations]]

[[illegible]] the field *[[illegible]]*

And *[[illegible]]* from the earth *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] flowers *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] some old *[[illegible]]*

Thy cliffs *[[illegible]]* overhanging shore

Perchance *[[illegible]]*

And *[[illegible]]* all thy *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] and *[[sternly?]]* *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] all *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: final two lines and revisions]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 29]]

[[Thither?]], ere gone, till hearts *[[inserted: brave]]* as fondly

And duly true, yet cant avert the stroke

As thine the long gone, perished ages gave

[[illegible]] the vale and dell, as sweetly *[[illegible]]*

Of Love, Happiness and fondly *[[dream?]]*

Then they in after years will *[[inserted: mark]]* the *[[deleted: illegible]]*
 Of *[[illegible]]* *[[this?]]* *[[Where?]]* *[[illegible]]*
 A few, few years, but dont *[[change?]]* them *[[illegible]]*
 Old, gaunt, and bald, and *[[inserted: hope]]* *[[illegible]]*
[[deleted: The]] *[[illegible]]* and stern, yet *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] with youth grown *[[inserted: hoar]]*
 That beaming mirth on *[[hope's?]]* *[[illegible]]*
 We'll leave to pride and *[[illegible]]*
 To be, as now we, hope so, blest as these
[[illegible]] we *[[illegible]]* with thy gentle smile
 That bids the care of day, depart, depart
 Their all, then back, *[[home?]]* once again
 And *[[illegible]]* will *[[illegible]]* our *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: final line]]

Editorial note. This is a severely faded draft with many deletions and interlinear alternatives. The text is a partial reading only. Manuscript page numbers are 28–29. The fragment is unsigned and undated; neither the surrounding account dates nor the collection name establish its author. Where an insertion cannot be placed securely, it is retained beside its apparent line rather than treated as a certain final version. A clearer related version is the Apostrophe to the Brazos, read 10-059, 10-058, 10-055. Draft wording and revisions can differ; unread text here is not silently replaced by the later version.

Scan 017 10-017

Verse on death, memory, and the generations that follow

10-017-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 30]]*
[[illegible]] of *[[illegible]]*
 Cling round *[[illegible]]*
 And *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: one line]]
[[illegible]] with all the *[[illegible]]*
 Of *[[illegible]]* *[[inserted: not]]* *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] as *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: revised line]]
[[illegible]] those *[[untimely?]]* *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] thy own *[[sterile?]]* hills
[[illegible]] wreaths of *[[inserted: fair]]* flowers
 And whose *[[illegible]]* the midnight *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] thoughts, of *[[illegible]]*
 Oft, *[[illegible]]* thy endless *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] by *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] their *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] gone
[[illegible]] in *[[illegible]]* fall *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: final two lines]]
[[separate block: manuscript page 31]]
 These scenes these thoughts awake and we forget
 The Indian's grave, the white man's Sepulchre

They lived, they loved, the joys and follies, but yet
 Death came and severed all those ties so dear
 That bound them unto life, and that we here
 Idly listless, mourn their venerated dust
 And desecrate the tombs affections tear
 Have reared to consecrate, and guard the just
 Beyond *[[deleted: Time's]]* *[[inserted: the tomb's]]* *[[illegible]]* or dark oblivions rust.
 Soon shall we pass away, nor *[[illegible]]* behind
 To tell what we have been, a single trace
 Like some frail gossamer, wafted by the wind
 We'll go and none may ever mark the place
 Where we may fall, & this *[[ready?]]* busy race
 Will have no time to pause, when we are gone
 The young and gay, will laugh around the *[[illegible]]*
 Of Life's *[[illegible]]* will lead them *[[on?]]*
[[deleted: illegible]] *[[illegible]]* shall *[[illegible]]* the *[[part?]]* they *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. Probably a continuation of the draft on 10-016, but the faint wording prevents a secure reconstruction of every transition. Page 30 is especially difficult. Page 31 supplies several continuous lines; missing words have not been supplied simply to complete rhyme or meter. This remains an unsigned, undated draft. A clearer related version is the Apostrophe to the Brazos, read 10-059, 10-058, 10-055. Draft wording and revisions can differ; unread text here is not silently replaced by the later version. A focused comparison with the clearer poem enabled correction of several words on manuscript page 31, followed by a fresh visual check of the draft. The earlier provisional opening "Years come, our forms resemble" was rejected; the visible line reads "These scenes these thoughts awake." Remaining differences and gaps are retained.

Scan 018 10-018

Further verse revisions and a page of arithmetic

10-018-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 32, continuation of verse]]*
[[illegible]] the *[[illegible]]* of *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: revised line]]
[[illegible]] made and *[[illegible]]*
 Type of thy *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] thy *[[illegible]]*
 Of *[[illegible]]* their life long *[[illegible]]*
 When care *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] *[[inserted: ills all]]* *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] in Death *[[illegible]]*
[[inserted: a busy life's work still half undone]]
[[illegible: overlapping revisions]]
[[illegible]] until we come
[[illegible]] youth, the *[[illegible]]* of *[[illegible]]*
 To the day *[[illegible]]* last *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] to *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible]] to come
[[separate block: manuscript page 33, calculations]]
[[635?]] *[[6.08?]]*

760)12938[[8?]]

760

2738 369

1300 950

56460

5

282300

3

20)846900(44

[[760?]]

86

70

[[169?]]

25

140

[[96?]]

[[illegible]]

Editorial note. The verse is probably a continuation of 10-016–017. Pencil and darker revisions overlap. The inserted phrase about “a busy life’s work still half undone” is readable, but the connecting words are not. The right page contains independent scratch arithmetic, not a dated or named financial account. The layout is represented in successive groups; no corrected mathematical result is supplied. A clearer related version is the Apostrophe to the Brazos, read 10-059, 10-058, 10-055. Draft wording and revisions can differ; unread text here is not silently replaced by the later version.

Scan 019 10-019

A faint poem, possibly headed “Invocation”

10-019-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 34]]*

[[Invocation?]]

There’s a cold bleak [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] gazing [[illegible]]

And [[illegible]] home in the

[[illegible]] gale

And the [[illegible]] howls

[[illegible]] sky

[[illegible]] flying [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] the [[illegible]]

But [[illegible]] we [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] thy [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] friendship [[illegible]]

[[illegible: three lines]]

[[illegible]] the [[illegible]]

And [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] the [[illegible]]

[[separate block: scratch figures below verse]]

[[illegible]]

[[212?]]

28

[[240?]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 35, top calculation]]

2200 750

2214 [[25?]]

4414 [[775?]]

[[illegible]]

[[separate block: verse continued]]

[[illegible]] dreary

[[illegible]] care

But one heart still [[illegible]]

[[beating?]] for you

[[illegible]] dear [[illegible]]

[[illegible: two lines]]

[[illegible]] returning [[illegible]]

Thou [[illegible]] to [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] my [[illegible]]

And speak peace [[illegible]]

[[illegible: four lines]]

[[illegible]] memory

[[illegible]]

Editorial note. Both pages are very faint. The title is tentative, and only fragments of the poem can currently be read securely. The wording and broken lineation should not be treated as a complete edition. Scratch calculations above and below the verse are separate. No named author, recipient, or date is legible.

Scan 020 10-020

An alliterative prose exercise using words beginning with A

10-020-P01 [[separate block: manuscript page 36]]

[[Allan?]] [[illegible: three words]]

Amiable and affable [[illegible]]

Allan an Anchorite an

Abrupt address affirming

an admiration [[illegible]]

an angelic [[adorer?]] allowable

[[illegible]], Admiration [[deleted: illegible]]

[[illegible]] admonition affinity

and [[illegible]] allow [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] adumbrating an

attachment actually attaining

an amicable [[illegible]] [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] affection. [[Albert?]] an

[[deleted: illegible]] assemblage [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] an [[inserted: assaying]] attitude and

[[illegible]] [[essays?]] an

attentive audition

[[separate block: manuscript page 37]]

An *[[illegible]]* *[[apparent?]]*

annunciation, awakening an

affectionate agitation *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] assemblage

[[illegible]] *[[an?]]* *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] only *[[illegible]]*

an affable *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. This appears to be a wordplay or composition exercise, built largely from A-words. The heading and much of the text are faint. Names such as Allan and Albert are tentative readings within the exercise and are not evidence about family members. The transcription preserves legible words without supplying a coherent sentence where the source cannot be read.

Scan 021 10-021

Faint verse with references to dreams, silence, and desolation

10-021-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 38]]*

[[illegible]] “to dream”

[[illegible: first four lines]]

[[illegible]] to gaze *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] my *[[duties?]]*

[[illegible]] as *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: one line]]

[[illegible]] when *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] in *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] from *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: one line]]

[[illegible]] over *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] thy *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]]

[[illegible]] that glare

[[separate block: manuscript page 39]]

No answer comes *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: revised line]]

Silence and gloom *[[illegible]]*

Companions alway

Lonely as if I had *[[illegible]]* the

Seas deepest Soundings

Where the *[[uncoffined?]]* dead

Lie mouldering away

Oh when will this cease, this

Dread desolation

Which binds my soul down

In *[[illegible]]* tribulation

Is there *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: line]]

No morning *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: final line]]

Editorial note. The pencil is very faint across both pages. This record marks the extent of the unresolved writing and preserves scattered words; it is not a continuous reading. “To dream” may be part of a heading or revision. No author or date is supplied. A clearer related version appears at 10-047, Bachelor’s Lament, dated July 1875. The draft has variant wording; its missing words are not mechanically filled from that copy. A focused visual comparison with 10-047 recovers several lines on manuscript page 39; the draft says “Lonely as if I had,” differing from the clearer version. Unread wording remains marked.

Scan 022 10-022

“We are growing old together Jim”

10-022-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 40]]*

We are growing old together Jim
 The years come swiftly on
 Our locks are growing hoar & slim
 Our youth days are gone
 Some thirty years have winged their *[[inserted: flight]]*
 Since you and I were born
 We’ve culled some flowers the fair & *[[inserted: bright]]*
 And felt the piercing thorn
 Where is our gentle *[[Mary?]]* now
 Who owned our early *[[troth?]]*
 What sorrows now *[[are?]]* *[[inserted: know]]* what
 What cares may compass both
 Perhaps beside some rippling stream
 Where murmuring waters flow
 They realize a fate *[[serene?]]*
 Which we may never know
[[separate block: manuscript page 41]]
 2 The *[[chalk scene?]]* *[[are?]]* *[[fickle?]]* *[[illegible]]*
 With all our boyhoods games
 The Bat & ball but never mind
 They’re unforgotten names
 5 The sunny scenes of “long ago”
 Are hid by clouds & gloom
 And many a Winters icy *[[blast?]]*
 Has nipt the Summers bloom
 7 We may not follow where *[[inserted: they’ve]]* gone
 Our paths have sundered wide
 But still within the Great Beyond
 There is nothing can divide
 8 Our comrades now *[[deleted: illegible]]* *[[inserted: that were]]* gay *[[illegible]]*
 Thro many a frolic & *[[illegible]]*
 Some fell beneath an *[[illegible]]*
 Some sleep where *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The poem has numbered stanzas distributed across the facing pages; the transcript follows the physical page order. Several lines are revised, including the line beginning “What sorrows.” The final stanza on page 41 is incomplete in this reading. A poem’s reference to Jim or to thirty years is not independent evidence for a family member’s age or identity. Continuation: 10-023.

Scan 023 10-023

“Enough—we too must go”: the ending of the poem to Jim

10-023-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 42]]*

Our golden dreams of a better time

Are gone with the gleaming Past

Such raptured visions of *[[youth?]]*

Were all too bright to last

[[separate block: manuscript page 43]]

Why we are left to tell the tale

We may not ask to know

Enough—we feel Lifes piercing *[[inserted: pains]]*

Enough—we too must go

Editorial note. Continuation of 10-022. “Pains” is written above the third line of the final stanza. The poem is unsigned; its speaker’s experience is not automatically that of the notebook’s owner.

Scan 024 10-024

Undated arithmetic on manuscript pages 46 and 49

10-024-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 46, calculations]]*

260130

1120644

2234295

3.6)1569(64066

30876

[[327467?]]

2584

1429

[[separate block: additional calculation on page 46]]

1244

907

1244

[[illegible]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 49, calculations]]

2688

962

1726

1144

2)2870

1435

1557

10045

7175

7175

1435

2234295

[[separate block: second calculation on page 49]]

1344

200

1144

1344

2488

1244

Editorial note. These pages contain scratch arithmetic without names, units, or transaction descriptions. Some figures overlap. The manuscript numbering jumps from 43 on the preceding scan to 46 and 49 here; no unprovided intervening pages have been reconstructed. Source PDF scan-page numbering remains continuous.

Scan 025 10-025

Verse beside a rocky shore; faint writing and arithmetic

10-025-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 50]]*

Lo! where yon lone *[[willow?]]* along

[[illegible]] rocky shore

And spreading *[[blossoms?]]* its

Gracefully *[[illegible]]* bowing *[[far?]]*

Dear *[[illegible]]* I love to while

The strangest hours away

With *[[illegible]]* free at the

Close of *[[illegible]]* declining day

[[separate block: faint lower writing]]

[[illegible]] 23 1873

[[illegible: about eight faint lines]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 51]]

Lifes Stormy *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: about eleven faint lines of verse]]

[[separate block: arithmetic below the verse]]

[[190?]]

140

2

280

70

350

490

840

187

1027

[[separate block: neighboring calculation]]

140

3½

420

70

490

*[[separate block: isolated figures]]**[[120?]]*

169

Editorial note. The darker opening verse and the faint lower material are distinguished. The date-like line includes “23 1873,” but the month and its relationship to the verse cannot be established. The right-page heading begins “Lifes Stormy”; its final word and most of the verse remain unreadable. This partial reading does not substitute a known poem for the manuscript.

Scan 026 10-026

A poem of bereavement beside property calculations

10-026-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 52]]*

Alas Still Memories *[[thus?]]* Keeps

[[illegible]]

The friends of my youth *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]]

Their pale forms *[[illegible]]* on the

[[yon?]] distant *[[highways?]]*

And beckon me on to the stygian

Shore

Beneath yon mound where the

willow stands weeping

The *[[darling?]]* of my heart is

[[deleted: illegible]] *[[inserted: there]]* sleeping

[[illegible]] the death angel be in

haste with his reaping

And gather *[[inserted: me]]* there to sleep as *[[inserted: well]]*

[[separate block: manuscript page 55, property notes and calculations]]

[[Waggons?]] 100

[[Buggy?]] 35

[[Horse?]] *[[illegible]]*

[[Mules?]] *[[illegible]]*

51235

148

36435

18217

2275

[[175?]]

[[separate block: lower inventory and figures]]

300 horses

74 hogs

120 cattle

40 *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible: three entries]]

510

148

362

2)362

181

[[separate block: neighboring figures]]

142

71

[[illegible]]

120

73

[[58095?]]

[[separate block: inverted words]]

[[illegible]]

Editorial note. The poem is unsigned and cannot be assumed to record a particular family death. A reference to the Stygian shore is retained as poetic language. On the facing page, the figures before horses, hogs, and cattle may be values rather than animal counts; the units are not stated clearly. Similar 51235/148/36435 arithmetic is repeated more clearly on 10-027. Manuscript numbers 52 and 55 are as seen. A clearer related version appears at 10-047, Bachelor's Lament, dated July 1875. The draft has variant wording; its missing words are not mechanically filled from that copy.

Scan 027 10-027

Personal-property division and an undated purchase list

10-027-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 56]]*

51235 Personal P

148 Debt

36435 left

18217 one half

2275 one Eighth

[[separate block: manuscript page 57, purchase list]]

1 *[[illegible: crossed item]]* 1 25

1 *[[illegible: crossed item]]* 1 75

1 Small *[[pld?]]* *[[illegible]]*

9 yds *[[illegible: crossed material]]* 12 1 08

6 yds jeans 60 3 60

1 *[[gro?]]* *[[illegible]]* paper

1 *[[illegible: heavily crossed item]]* Bk

1 pr *[[illegible]]* *[[brass?]]*

Nails 8 5 *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] 10 5

1 Box *[[illegible]]*

[[separate block: marginal words and figures]]

[[illegible]]

Editorial note. "Personal P" is retained as an abbreviation, probably personal property. The arithmetic has not been corrected; decimal places are not supplied in the reference transcript. Many purchase-list items are crossed through, which may mark completion rather than textual deletion. The legible remaining quantities and amounts are preserved. Neither the property owner nor the purpose of the division is named.

Scan 028 10-028

Salt, coffee, porter, and miscellaneous calculations

10-028-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 60, calculations]]*

4983

[[illegible]]

4983

[[485?]]

249

5727

5240

2)10967

5483

36.64

8

22

66.64

7.50

59.14

54.83

15.75

39.08

54.83

35.75

19.8

[[separate block: sideways memorandum]]

Pirates *[[illegible]]*

from *[[Sinclair?]]*

Geiss Bk for *[[illegible]]*

[[separate block: name or word among figures]]

[[Bethlehem?]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 61, purchases]]

1 Bk Salt 4.60

Coffee 20.25

Porter 7.50

1 Bag & *[[illegible]]* 2.00

36.35

25

36.60

18.70

[[55.30?]]

[[separate block: further calculations]]

16967
 [[8220?]]
 [[57.47?]]
 [[4?]]
 70
 [[64.57?]]
 63.85
 57.47
 6.38
 54.83
 36.50
 18.33
 18.33
 19.8
 [[37.41?]]
 43.42
 37.4
 [[6.35?]]
 7.00
 [[illegible]]

Editorial note. The spread contains overlapping calculations and short side notes. A few decimal points and digits remain uncertain. "Bk" is not securely expanded; the word read as Porter is preserved without deciding whether it denotes a commodity or a person. The side notes do not support identifying a named individual without further context. No attempt is made to reconcile the several independent calculations.

Scan 029 10-029

Waxahachie pen trials and scratch arithmetic

10-029-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 62, pen trials and arithmetic]]*

Waxahachie
 Waxahachie
 W W W
 Scribbling
[[deleted: Scribbling]]
 Waxahachie
 Ellis County
 Texas *[[illegible]]*
[[separate block: first calculations]]
 1040
 [[945?]]
 [[24?]]
 6.35
 2)44.00
 44
 55
 220

68 20

17

37

15

185

370

555

20

650

925

1040

115

97

5

485

555

1040

134

[[separate block: right-hand calculations]]

50

[[illegible]]

400

370

770

90

5

850

[[illegible]]

[[97?]]

[[illegible: overlapping figures]]

1120

115

[[illegible]]

1430

[[separate block: manuscript page 65]]

[[blank]]

Editorial note. The place-name pen trials explicitly include Waxahachie, Ellis County, and Texas. They do not establish residence or a date. Some arithmetic overlaps and cannot be read consistently. The facing page is numbered 65 and contains no substantive entry.

Scan 030 10-030

Two land sketches, one labeled J. D. Orr

10-030-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 68, land sketch]]*

J. D. Orr

[[50?]] acres

[[separate block: labels around the boundary]]

548

372

813

[[241?]]

150

N 44½ E

N 13 W

[[separate block: manuscript page 69, irregular land sketch]]

1344

200

[[N 20 W?]]

[[544?]]

[[525?]]

N 14 W

1760

950

841

1344

841

[[1606?]]

Editorial note. The left sketch is an irregular five-sided outline labeled J. D. Orr and tentatively 50 acres. Its bottom boundary is labeled 813; the top 548; right 372; two slanting sides have 150 and a less certain 241, with bearing extensions. The right sketch has an irregular left boundary and a rectangular indentation on the right. Labels are transcribed around each figure, but a textual list does not reproduce the geometry. Units and ownership are not stated; a survey name alone does not prove title to land. The handwritten page numbers appear to be 68 and 69.

Scan 031 10-031

"Fear not my Little One"

10-031-P01 *[[separate block: verse written across manuscript pages 70–71]]*

Fear not my Little One The *[[illegible]]* have lowered

Around our dwelling *[[illegible]]* thick and fast

Bright as your *[[illegible]]* beams *[[illegible]]*

Now *[[illegible]]* the *[[illegible]]* storm has *[[illegible]]* at last

In Light and *[[illegible]]* perfume *[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The five lines run across the gutter of the open notebook. They are transcribed as continuous lines across the spread, not as independent left and right page poems. Fading and the gutter prevent a complete reading. The fragment is unsigned and does not identify a child.

Scan 032 10-032

An irregular survey sketch and an area calculation

10-032-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 74, survey sketch]]*

230

400

545

[[367?]]

[[separate block: manuscript page 75, calculation]]

785

805

3925

6280

5646)631925(11

5646

6732

5646

10865

1129

427

Editorial note. The left drawing includes intersecting diagonal lines and labels 230, 400, 545, and a less certain 367. The drawn outline reaches the page edge; the transcript lists its labels but does not reproduce the geometry. The facing arithmetic is preserved without correction or an asserted final acreage. Some spacing is ambiguous, especially in the long-division work.

Scan 033 10-033

Survey courses using an elm and a branch as landmarks

10-033-P01 [[separate block: manuscript page 76]]

A Stake in N Line of

[[illegible]]. An Elm 14 in Dia

N [[21?]] E 9 vs

Thence N 30 E 230 v [[C. A. ?]]

Down said branch 400 vs

S 60° E

Thence 545 vs N 30 E

north side Branch

[[illegible]] 7 in E

[[separate block: manuscript page 77]]

686 S 40 W

180 S 30 E

475 S 60 W

Editorial note. This fragment describes a stake, an elm 14 inches in diameter, and a branch. “vs” is the source’s surveying abbreviation, read as varas in the family version. The initial property name or reference, one bearing, and the closing tree description remain uncertain. These notes do not identify a complete parcel or owner.

Scan 034 10-034

A hackberry landmark, Sublett reference, and survey arithmetic

10-034-P01 [[separate block: manuscript page 78]]

S W corner [[C. J. ?]] [[illegible]]

A Hackberry S 40 E 3¾ [[vs?]]

N 30 E 4 [[illegible]]

1760 vs Subletts E

[[separate block: manuscript page 79, survey sketch labels]]

1344

[[173?]]

180

[[illegible]]

112

[[illegible]]

1770

278

[[separate block: calculations beside and below sketch]]

112

180

1301

2688

1587

795

6835

12085

9101

5646)102665(18

5646

46205

45168

[[1037?]]

173

18

54

245

Editorial note. The surname Sublett is legible in a distance note, but the preceding property or person is not securely identified. The drawing includes a narrow side strip and cross-lines; several labels are faint. The arithmetic is transcribed without forcing its figures to agree. "vs" is expanded as varas in the family reading.

Scan 035 10-035

Purchases from Bates and Ellis & White, February–April 1874

10-035-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 80]]*

Feby 12 1874

Bought of Bates

1 Side of Leather \$ *[[9.00?]]*

[[separate block: inverted calculations]]

880

580

300

1760

3

2)5280

1320

6600

2

7800

2

15600

3900

19500

14340

33840

[[14825?]]

48625

405

[[261?]]

907

[[1235?]]

955

5

4775

655

14340

37

4

148

[[separate block: manuscript page 81]]

Feby 18. 1874

Bought of Ellis & White

2 Pr Hames 2 50

1 " Shoes 2 25

5 yds No 5 84

½ doz Buckles 12

By Elbert Winniford 5 71

April 25 1874

3 yds Hickory 20 60

3 " Do 18 54

1 Hat 4 00

1 Pencil 10

1 Day Book 10

1 Handkerchief 40

1 Shirt Bosom 60

1 Box collars 25

Tobacco 1 00

Total 7 59

Editorial note. The leather price is somewhat faint. The February 18 purchase list names Elbert Winniford as intermediary ("By"), not necessarily buyer or recipient. The April 25 list has no repeated supplier heading. "No 5" is

retained without guessing a fabric type. The inverted arithmetic on page 80 is separate and is not assumed to relate to the leather purchase.

Scan 036 10-036

Household goods, clothing materials, honey, and a payment, 1874

10-036-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 82]]*

June 3 1874

1 Bucket Tin

1 Pan Block Tin

11 lbs *[[Soda?]]* 2 43

2 yds Denim 25 50

6½ " *[[Cassimere?]]* 100 6 50

3 Spools 25

Buttons Coat 20

1 Box Collars 25

1 Grease Box 30

1 Comb 40

Buttons Dress 10

Oct 1 1874

2 Buckets 35 70

5 yds Calico 62

2 Tin Dishes 25

Sugar 1 50

13 61

[[separate block: manuscript page 83]]

June 23 1874

Paid Ellis White \$10.00

12¾ lbs Honey 12½ 1 58

[[separate block: calculations]]

1121

336

785

545

2)1330

665

200

133000

549

785

2745

4392

3843

430965

965

475

4825

6755

3860

458375

[[separate block: neighboring calculations]]

571

759

1350

2680

2399

5079

1152

3927

4095

168

Editorial note. Prices for the first two tinware items are not separately clear. The food or household item read as Soda and the cloth name remain tentative. The June 23 entry records payment to Ellis & White and a honey entry; the direction of the honey transaction is not specified. The scratch arithmetic is transcribed in groups without reconciliation or assuming it belongs to these purchases.

Scan 037 10-037

Overlapping arithmetic and a faint purchase list

10-037-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 84, calculations]]*

133000

430965

458375

5644)1022340(18

5646

45774

45188

5860

[[separate block: neighboring calculations]]

2680

336

2344

1569

775

630

180

845

1504

678

846

475

371

[[separate block: manuscript page 85, faint list beneath calculations]]

[[illegible: approximately eight lines of purchases or quantities]]

[[separate block: overlying calculations]]

761

619

142

2)903

451

151

155

306

1567

150

1387

1567

451

1567

7835

6268

5646)706717(125

5646

14217

1129[[0?]]

29197

28230

967

[[separate block: small neighboring calculation]]

1369

640

[[729?]]

[[separate block: bottom entry]]

1 Box *[[illegible]]* 240

Editorial note. These calculations overlap a lighter purchase list. The underlying list is too faint and obscured for a reliable full reading; it is explicitly marked rather than silently omitted. The displayed results are retained even where the copied figures appear inconsistent. The purpose of the calculations is not identified.

Scan 038 10-038

R. B. Potter's corn account, August 1, 1874

10-038-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 86]]*

R. B. Potter

Aug 1st 1874

Acct with R. B. Potter

To 16 Bu corn 75 12 00

To settlement with Gibson

5 Bu corn 75 3 75

[[separate block: calculations below the account]]

16

75

80

11200

2220

4)2220

555

2070

150

2220

1200

5)1020

204

5

284

640

356

3)1780

593

560

80

480

5

2400

200

5)2600

[[514?]]

640

[[80?]]

560

204

356

[[separate block: manuscript page 89, calculation groups]]

1567

1344

2)2911

1455½

303

4365

4365

[[illegible]]

441015

1059

303

2)756

378
 1567
 1780
 2)3347
 1673½
 388
 13064
 8165
 4879
 499
 [[584178?]]
 441015
 5646)1025808(181
 5646
 46123
 45168
 9558
 5446
 [[33112?]]
 5446)971603(17[[illegible]]
 [[illegible: overlapping lower calculations]]

Editorial note. The named account records corn and a settlement involving Gibson. The extensive arithmetic below and on the facing page is not assumed to be part of Potter's account. Several overlapping figures are unresolved. Manuscript numbers appear as 86 and 89; missing intervening numbers have not been filled with invented pages.

Scan 039 10-039

Robison accounts: plow repairs, lumber, sawing, and fence posts, 1874

10-039-P01 [[separate block: manuscript page 90]]

Acct [[W. H. ?]] Robison

March 20 1874

To Sharpening 1 Plow 25

" Repairing plow foot

" Making Clevis for

Double tree

Credit by 95

May 22 1874

To Sharp 1 Plow 25

June 13 1874

Acct in all 2 30

Sept Repairs on Waggon ax

2 nuts 1 Bolt 4 inch

6 Bolts ½ in by 4 inch

[[separate block: manuscript page 91]]

Acct [[J. J. ?]] Robison Dr Cr

March 10 1874

600 ft C. F. 6 50
 1 day Sawing 2 50
 March 28 1874
[[160?]] ft C f 4 00
 March 1874
 55 Fence Posts
 & 4 Double 5 90
 19 00
 Credit to *[[Bal Acct?]]* 4 55
 Credit June 13 1874 10 00
[[separate block: calculation]]
 19 00
 455
 1445

Editorial note. The surnames appear as Robison in the headings; the earlier index uses Robinson. Both sets of initials are tentative and should not be conflated. The left and right accounts contain work and reciprocal credits, but the direction of every entry is not established. The written total 19.00 and intermediate figures have not been adjusted to force agreement.

Scan 040 10-040

J. J. Gibson's lumber account and a flour credit, 1872–1873

10-040-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 92, calculation groups]]*
 1727 1800 2055 863
 841 841 888 25
 886 1059 1300 888
 168000
 127716
 40284
 4
[[4000284?]]
[[illegible: dense overlapping calculations across the page]]
[[separate block: inverted note below the calculations]]
 Acct with Ellis *[[illegible]]*
[[8 1815?]]
[[separate block: manuscript page 93]]
 J. J. Gibsons acct Dr Cr
 Oct 23 1872
 554 ft c f 13.85 10.00
 Nov 23
 780 ft c f 17.00
 100 " c f For Latting 2.50
 71 " Scantling 1.77 10.90
 Jan 7 1873
 570 " c f 14.25 12.00
 Feb 1873

300 " c f *[[per?]]* *[[Calder?]]* 7.50 7.50
 57.37 40.40
 44.90 *[[illegible]]*
 12.47 *[[illegible]]*
[[separate block: additional calculation]]
[[22.75?]]
[[separate block: credit note]]
 Credit by one
 Sack flour from
[[B. S.?]] Douglas
[[separate block: diagonal annotation]]
[[illegible]]

Editorial note. Large diagonal strokes cross the account, apparently a settlement mark; the entries remain transcribed. The intermediary for the February lumber and the initials before Douglas are not secure. The page 92 calculation field is densely overlapping and only partly recoverable. Written subtotals are preserved rather than recomputed.

Scan 041 10-041

A lumber sale to D. A. Sweatt through Henry Davis

10-041-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 94, faint notes and pen trials]]*
[[Benton?]] *[[illegible]]* 20.00
 W. *[[illegible]]* 25.00
 L. *[[illegible]]* *[[25.00?]]*
[[illegible: large pen trials]]
[[separate block: calculations]]
 393
 240
 2358
 1572
 786
 96678
 4840
 20
 96800
 618
 125
 393
 122
 271
[[366?]]
 60
 40
 20
 20
 50

190

[[separate block: manuscript page 97]]

Jan 14. 1873

Sold to D. A. Sweatt

Nov 26 1872 by

Henry Davis

200 ft c f 5 00

[[separate block: calculations below entry]]

250 571

225 759

84 1350

12 2680

571 24

759 5080

1330 1158

[[4770?]] 3922*[[illegible]]*

Editorial note. The page is headed January 14, 1873, but the sale itself is dated November 26, 1872. Both dates are retained; the former may be a posting date. Large flourishes obscure the faint notes on manuscript page 94. The calculation blocks are not assigned to the sale. The right page number appears to be 97.

Scan 042 10-042

Dunn and *[[Worley?]]* lumber entries, 1872–187310-042-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 98, arithmetic]]*

336 1344

146 146

2016 1198

1344

336

49056

5644)49056(8

45188

[[4868?]]

1198

3800

80

1198

380

35840

3594

[[445540?]]

45188

*[[3360?]]**[[illegible: further overlapping calculations]]**[[separate block: manuscript page 99]]*

Jan 14 1873
 Sold to Dunn &
[[Worley?]] Nov 24
 1872
 30 ft Strips 75
 March 22 /73
 175 ft c f 4 35

Editorial note. As on the preceding spread, a January 14, 1873 heading accompanies an older sale dated November 24, 1872. The second surname remains uncertain. The March 22 entry resembles Tom Dunn's 175-foot entry on 10-012, but the headings are preserved separately. The left page contains overlapping arithmetic and is only partly legible.

Scan 043 10-043

Ornamental pen practice and a scantling account

10-043-P01 *[[separate block: manuscript page 100, ornamental writing]]*

[[Stays?]] *[[illegible]]*

[[Stays?]] *[[illegible]]* the

[[illegible]] to me *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]]

[[illegible]]

[[illegible]]

with *[[illegible]]*

County of Ellis

[[separate block: arithmetic under and around pen trials]]

[[illegible: numerous overlapping calculations]]

[[separate block: facing account page]]

Jan 14 1873

Acct against *[[Reaves?]]*

86 ft Scantling 2 15

[[separate block: calculations]]

1021

180

841

[[871?]]

1560)49000(31½

4680

2200

1560

640

1560

441

44

4)397

99

4)260

65

300

31½

3

94½

11½

1034

[[illegible]]

1086

65

1021

[[illegible: further rotated or overwritten calculations]]

Editorial note. The large, elaborate lettering appears to be pen practice rather than a signed document. Most phrases are not securely readable; “County of Ellis” is clear. The facing page records a named account, but the surname is tentative. The arithmetic is not silently reconciled. The lettering covers older figures on page 100.

Scan 044 10-044

Douglas name practice and inside-cover arithmetic

10-044-P01 [[separate block: pen trials on the last notebook leaf]]

Douglas

Sometime

Sometime

[[illegible]]

[[Stays?]] [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] Douglass

Douglass

Douglas

[[illegible]] Douglas

County of [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] Douglas [[illegible]]

[[illegible]] Plantation

[[illegible: further ornamental phrases, letters, and overlapping arithmetic]]

[[separate block: inside back cover calculations]]

28

42

[[160?]]

178

[[1259?]]

[[3245?]]

134

[[6930?]]

[[3298?]]

[[illegible]]

1145

[[illegible]]

1265

[[1781?]]

[[illegible: digit trials and additional faint calculations]]

Editorial note. Multiple forms of Douglas/Douglass appear in ornamental pen practice. The flourish before the surname is not a securely identified given name or signature. The word read as Plantation occurs among practice text and does not establish a particular property or occupation. The inside cover is worn and the arithmetic is fragmentary.

Scan 045 10-045

“Parody”: a rose offered in friendship, April 1868

10-045-P01 154

Parody.

10-045-P02 'Tis the first rose of Summer

Fresh blooming and fair

Which sheds its sweet fragrance

Upon the soft air;

Oh! how sweetly it blushes

Like a young maiden's cheek

When emotions are burning

The lip cannot speak.

10-045-P03 I'll not leave thee, thou fair one

To bloom on the stem,

But will gather thee gently

The days sweetest gem;

While the dewdrop yet lingers

Upon thy bright leaves;

As the tear on the lashes

When th'heart fondly grieves.

10-045-P04 And soon will I give thee

In Friendship's true name

To one who will prize thee

Through life still the same;

True hearts ne'er are withered

Tho' Youth's bloom be gone

And that Love is immutable

Where Friendship first shone.

10-045-P05 April 1868.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 154. No author's signature appears on this page. The heading “Parody” is retained without supplying an external source or attribution.

Scan 046 10-046

"To Emma," of Zephyrus Bower

10-046-P01 153

To Emma.

Of Zephyrus Bower,—By "Moore" the second.

10-046-P02 Part First.

Awake my sweet Lyre

To Love I aspire

Pure as the desire

Of Angels above

Hopes which I cherish

Never let perish

And cast a dark gloom

O'er Fancy's first bloom

But live forever

And flow as a river

A torrent of Love.

Then welcome the hour

It finds Emma's bower

Where by thy sweet power

I'm carried along;

The Muses around

Enchant The fair ground

With Music's sweet sound

A heavenly Song.

Then joy so complete

While at Emma's feet

I softly repeat

And for each word vouch

That fondly I love her

By all that's above her

And will till times over

My dear Emma Couch.

10-046-P03 Part Second

Awake my sweet Lyre

Affections desire

A heavenly fire

Courses my veins

Oh! let thy sweet sound

Come floating around

With gentle rebound

In melodious strains;

For Emma divine

Will never be mine

Unless I can shine
 By Poesy's power.
 For no other score
 Will I go before
 A second "Tom Moore"
 To zephyrus bower,
 But that me will raise
 I fondly surmise
 And in Emma's eyes
 Perhaps may succeed
 Then Life will be bright
 And joyous and light,
 And in young Love's sight
 Elysium indeed.

10-046-P04 Part Third.
 Awake my sweet Lyre
 You know my desire;
 Oh! now go and fire
 Another young heart
 Thus you will prove
 That you can wake Love
 In Bower or Grove
 Wherever you start.
 Let Love's sweetest Song
 Thy cadence prolong
 While moving along
 That verdant bower
 Whose perfumes shaken
 Emma will waken
[[separate block: final two lines in the right margin]]
 To live the peerless
 Maid of thy bower.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 153, in two columns. Part Second runs from the bottom of the left column to the top of the right; Part Third ends in two rotated margin lines. "Moore" the second and "Tom Moore" are the poem's own descriptions, not a verified attribution. "times over" is reproduced as written. The text names Emma Couch, but neither her identity nor a historical relationship is established here.

Scan 047 10-047

"Bachelor's Lament," July 1875

10-047-P01 Bachelor's Lament.
 July 1875

10-047-P02 O! where is the hope of the vine covered cottage
 The visions of Youth will so oft conjure up
 Forever 'tis gone, and now gray in my dotage

I've drained to the dregs Life's bitterest cup.
 And where is the dear One I've loved with devotion
 Thro' life's changeful scenes of unhallowed commotion
 With ever the same constant and changeless emotion
 Beloved at the first and beloved to the close.

10-047-P03 No answer comes back from my voiceless surroundings
 For silence and gloom are my comrades always,
 I'm sad as if sunk 'neath the Sea's deepest Soundings
 Where the *[[deleted: uncoffined dead]]* *[[inserted: dead of the past]]* lie mould'ring away,
 O! when will this cease here, this dread desolation
 Which binds my soul down in its deep tribulation
 And is there no season of calm consolation
 No morning unfolding again as the rose?

10-047-P04 Alone now I wander on life's rugged byways
 The friends of my Youth I may never greet more
 For many have fallen on far distant highways
 And beckon me on to the Stygian shore;
 And 'neath yon low mound where the willow stands weeping
 My heart's only darling forever is sleeping
 O! may the Death Angel make haste with his reaping
 And gather me there to a dreamless repose!

10-047-P05 Forever shall cease then those ties that are breaking
 And sweetly I'll rest in the calm of the tomb.
 No storms can assail 'till the morn of awaking
 Shall beckon the dead back to joy or gloom—
 Around me shall linger no omen of danger
 Which compassed my way while a sad lonely ranger
 To all save a Peace—deep and dreamless a Stranger
 There calmly I'll rest from my life's gloomy woes.

Editorial note. A clearer version of passages also present in the faint notebook drafts at 10-021 and 10-026. The interlinear revision in stanza two is shown explicitly. No signature is visible. The poem's references to aging, a lost beloved, and death are literary statements; they do not by themselves establish the author's age, marital status, or a named person's death.

Scan 048 10-048

"To Victoria," concluding stanzas, July 1875

10-048-P01 75

Thus Inez to me was the dross in the gold
 The Midnight's dead shade o'er the hope of the soul
 The glowworm's cold light where poison vines weep
 Their death dealing dews in the dark forest deep.

10-048-P02 But back thro' the lapse of the shadowy years
 My Ida's sweet smile ever changeless appears

Ere the tempter invaded my Eden of Bliss
And destroyed my sweet flower, leaving me this.

10-048-P03 July 1875.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 75 continues manuscript page 74 at 10-049. Read 10-049 before 10-048. The date appears at the conclusion. The poem's charges against Inez and its account of Ida are not independently established biographical facts.

Scan 049 10-049

"To Victoria": welcome to Brushy

10-049-P01 74

To Victoria.

10-049-P02 Welcome Victoria! to Brushy's green slopes
The Cradle and Grave of my Bachelor hopes
Here they opened and flourished and fell in decay
As flowers nipt by a frost in the genial May.

10-049-P03 But why should I trouble you with Sorrows of Mine!
For thousands have felt them, and thousands repine
But may the kind Angel who is guarding thy way
Protect you from them wherever you Stray.

10-049-P04 Thrice happy the hours since to Brushy you came
For enjoyments exist now which were only a name;
And sweeter than roses the converse we hold
And the swift flying moments are brighter than gold.

10-049-P05 I speak not of Love, that fountain is dry
Deception and Falsehood have quenched its supply
Experience has taught me, the daughters of Eve
The fairest the brightest were born to deceive.

10-049-P06 Sweet Ida was fickle, but still in my heart
Her image is graven and will never depart,
But Inez with falsehood has stained her young fame
And the curse of a Douglas now rests on her name.

10-049-P07 Tell me why should the truthful one sympathy hold
For that glittering dross which alloys the gold
Or what what concord has night with the morn of the day
The glow worms cold glare with the sun's gentle ray.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 74. Continued at 10-048 (manuscript page 75), where the poem is dated July 1875. The repeated "what what" is retained. "A Douglas" appears in the poem, but it is not an author's signature. Brushy is not assigned to a specific modern location here. The accusations about Ida, Inez, and women generally are the speaker's rhetoric, not independently verified statements.

Scan 050 10-050

“On the Banks of Brushy”: remembered childhood landscapes

10-050-P01 13

On the Banks of Brushy.

10-050-P02 Fair Brushy! again beside thy winding stream

I rove again as in my childhood's days
 And with ardor dream again each early dream
 Which once beguiled my young artless ways;
 O'er them still my Memory fondly strays
 Sweet treasures of the Past forever fled
 And doomed to rot in dark Oblivion's maze
 Where all that's pure and bright is tending fast
 To mingle with Earth's common clay at last.

10-050-P03 Here first I heard the sky-lark's warbling notes

As it high ascended from its dewy nest:
 And here from a thousand other funny throats
 I heard the tones which swelled each tender breast
 Rising to Heaven as though they blest
 The great Creator's name with guileless heart
 Who had all things in such beauty drest
 And given them here fair Freedom's part
 Unstained by Man, with his dark wily art.

10-050-P04 Here too I culled the lovely flowers which grew

In rich profusion on each verdant lawn
 Adding their charms of every varied hue
 Which could not be restored when they were gone
 Then with listless steps I wandered on
 To seek for others still more sweet
 Until the approach of evening's dawn
 Homeward turned my wandering feet
 From many a pleasant flower adorned retreat.

10-050-P05 But ere from each pleasant landscape I withdrew

I culled from many a lone mossy glen
 The lovely violets which in rich profusion grew
 In every woodland brake and tangled fen—

Editorial note. Manuscript page 13, continuing at 10-051 (page 14). “Funny throats” and “evening's dawn” are retained as written. The speaker's childhood landscape is called Brushy, but the poem alone does not securely identify either its author or the geographical location. The complete identified reading order is 10-050, 10-051, 10-060, 10-061, 10-052, 10-053 (manuscript pages 13–18).

Scan 051 10-051

“On the Banks of Brushy”: flower battles and youthful ambition

10-051-P01 14

And naming each for earth’s illustrious men
 And counting signal numbers for each side,
 Vigorously began the mock battle—and when
 The flowery fight was done—and all but one had died
 O’er that Last victor my heart thrilled in boyish pride

10-051-P02 To think that I like it would triumph over all
 Who were arrayed against me as my foes
 That I would thus witness the last one fall
 Whom my right of sway would ever dare oppose.
 And of my life victory and peace would be the close
 Was the emblem which I saw in that flower
 And did not note how soon it died with those
 It had o’erthrown in battle’s stormy hour
 Yielding with them all unto a mightier power.

10-051-P03 But as those lovely flowers withering died
 Together in one fragrant floral heap
 So perished those early joys which were allied
 Unto the future where broad Fancy’s sweep
 Grasped the immortal and bade me keep
 An erect brow through swiftly coming years
 And clamber up Fame’s long wished steep
 Whose shaggy brow in the dim future rears
 Aloft above the rabble’s taunting jeers.

10-051-P04 But still those early scenes in freshness bloom
 Those brighter fancies of my childhood’s time
 Shine from afar, though intervening gloom
 And the wide distance gives them doubly the sublime
 Of Beauty, Glory, and Grandeur, which in their prime
 They wore unto my young enraptured eyes,
 As the measured feet of impassioned rhyme
 Lends dignity unto the writings of the wise
 Which Clothed in Poetry more majestically rise.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 14 continues 10-050 (page 13). It continues at 10-060 (page 15), then 10-061 (page 16), 10-052 (page 17), and 10-053 (page 18). The flower battle is explicitly a child’s game, not an account of a military engagement.

Scan 052 10-052

Childhood morning, school, and play: “On the Banks of Brushy” sequence

10-052-P01 17

But once more the sun is in the glowing east,

Once more the day has come beautiful and bright,
 Once more from Sweet Slumber's bond released
 All Nature hails the grand return of Light.
 Once more unto my eager ravished sight
 The dew drops sparkle brightly on a thousand flowers
 From the pure crimson to the spotless white
 Which richly glow in Nature's vernal bowers
 Adding sweetest perfumes to the returning hours.

10-052-P02 The lowing herds wandering forth to crop the grass
 O'er mead and hill in boundless pastures free
 The soft tinkling bells upon them as they pass
 Ringing on the morning air so merrily,
 And in a thousand brakes the song birds cheerily
 Hymning on High their Sweet discordant notes
 All forming *[[deleted: the sweetest]]* *[[inserted: a Sweeter]]* chorus *[[deleted: which]]* *[[inserted: than]]*
 ever we
 Have heard from any choirs of well trained throats
 As it through the Soft air, gently heavenward floats

10-052-P03 But the hour for School has come, we must along
 With Satchel and basket, and beneath the teachers eye
 Con our lessons over with a hum-drum Song
 With many a furtive glance at the bright blue sky
 And longing from the close School-room to fly
 To the cooling Stream or groves deep vernal shade
 Or o'er the flowery plain to chase the butterfly
 Where thro' the long hours of morning it has Strayed
 Sipping the sweet from the flowers where it has played.

10-052-P04 Hail glorious playtime! for awhile set free
 With wild shouts we hail thee in the open air
 Happy as any class of mortals well can be
 Having to pleasure now our odd hour to spare,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 17 follows the displaced pages 15 and 16 at 10-060 and 10-061. The final stanza continues at 10-053 (page 18). Revisions in the birdsong stanza are recorded rather than silently discarded.

Scan 053 10-053

Schoolboy friendship threatened by cruelty and slander

10-053-P01 18
 And laying aside every thought and care
 Which jocund joy might possibly impede
 And dividing into equal sides prepare
 For boyish games; and firing to nought else heed
 With laugh and shout the winged hours we speed.

10-053-P02 Thrice happy time! with no foreboding cares opprest
 The glowing hours in joy are winged away
 And present Hopes with full fruition blest
 Portend no shadows in Lifes evening day.
 Alas! that those should ever o'er us stray
 To blight young Friendship in the early bud
 And drown their first purest blessed joy
 Beneath dark Detractions turbid flood—
 Whose boiling tide inundates all that's good.

10-053-P03 Oh! why should the Schoolboys path of flowers
 Be lined with thorns at every step he treads?
 Oh! why should his Life's young gladsome bowers
 Conceal that Serpent in their floral beds
 Whose poisonous fangs obscured in hydra heads
 Of hate, malice, Scorn, Contempt, and pride,
 Strike with all their venom natively inbred
 Until the nobler passions of the heart have died
 Or with the baseness of Lucifer allied.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 18 continues the playtime stanza at 10-052. "Firing" appears in the line about paying no heed and is retained, although "giving" would be expected in context. The enlarged native scan resolves the end of the venom line as "natively inbred." This page has no separate title, date, or signature. The complete identified reading order is 10-050, 10-051, 10-060, 10-061, 10-052, 10-053 (manuscript pages 13–18).

Scan 054 10-054

"Things I Love," written for Miss Ida

10-054-P01 64

Things I Love

Written for Miss Ida;

10-054-P02 I love to love all lovely things
 From which the charm of Beauty *[[springs?]]*
 To captivate the heart,
 From lichens on the mountain crest
 To lowly vales in sunlight drest
 The high, the lowly part,
 The Hero's proud and pompous sway
 The Senate's stern command,
 The Ploughman's noteless little day,
 The humblest in our land,
 The grandly great, the low-*[[illegible]]*
 Alike possess a charm
 There's Splendor there, And Beauty here
 To keep the life blood warm,

10-054-P03 The mutual pledge and mutual trust
 Are joys which time can never rust

Nor lessen in degree
 They spring from heart to kindred heart
 And form of Life the sweeter part
 Whose *[[joys?]]* never flee
 Forms may decay, and friends grow strange
 And lovely objects fly,
 And Time's mute step, with silent change
 May bid the fairest die
 But these will e'er remain to cheer
 Tho' all beside are gone
 And Life be bright with roseate light,
 With one perpetual dawn,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 64; continues on manuscript page 65 at 10-057, then page 66 at 10-056. That concluding page is dated February 1873. Faded words are marked; the line beginning "The grandly great" is not completed from the rhyme or expected meaning. Miss Ida is not identified beyond the dedication.

Scan 055 10-055

"Apostrophe to the Brazos": concluding stanzas, June 1874

10-055-P01 63

Soon shall we pass away, nor leave behind
 To tell what we have been, a single trace
 Like some frail gossamer wafted by the wind
 We'll go, and none may ever mark the place
 Where we shall fall. Life's eager busy race
 Will have no time to pause. When we are gone
 The young the gay will laugh around, the chase
 Of Life's vain *[[phantoms?]]*, still will lead them on
 Until they too with us, shall try the Great Beyond.

10-055-P02 Flow on thou River, Still flow on. The Sea
 Will welcome thee to its deep dark abyss,
 Thy course is marked, and I can *[[mark?]]* in Thee
 The type of Human Life. Nor can we miss
 The doom awaiting us, The woe, the bliss
 Of that last hour, to which we all must come
 And there resign the pomp the fame of this
 In the deep sleep of our last quiet *[[illegible]]*
 Till called to swell the throng in yon eternal dome.

10-055-P03 June 1874.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 63, a conclusion whose river imagery and gossamer stanza also appear in the faint drafts at 10-016–10-018. Several words are faded even in the native scan. The place and duration of the speaker's life cannot be inferred from the general meditation on death. The opening is at 10-059 (page 61), followed by 10-058 (page 62) and this page (63).

Scan 056 10-056

"Things I Love": friendship and faith, February 1873

10-056-P01 66

And too, I love the friendly flow,
 The Social feelings' ardent glow
 The heart's *[[responsive?]]* beat
 The happy hours of Sunlit glee
 With friends commingling frank and *[[free?]]*
 The fireside's fond retreat,
 The mantling cheek and sparkling eye
 Which speak of Souls Sincere
 Of Hope and Aspiration high
 Which youthful bosoms bear,
 The mystic power, of Twilight's hour
 When stars begin to shine,
 The soft repose of daylight's close
 Are joys I number mine.

10-056-P02 But far above the grandest thing
 Which Earth can yield or Genius bring
 I prize the heirs of Heaven
 Who bow beneath the hand of God
 And smile thro' tears and kiss the rod
 Ere yet the blow is given,
 Lone Pilgrims still, and strangers here
 Amid a world of strife
 With practice pure, and conscience clear
 Their title deed to *[[Life?]]*,
 With living Faith that conquers death
 A high and holy trust
 They calmly wait, the last *[[mandate?]]*
 "Thou Shalt return to dust"

10-056-P03 Feby 1873

Editorial note. Manuscript page 66 concludes "Things I Love." Read 10-054 (page 64), 10-057 (page 65), then this page. Several words fade at a vertical band in the scan and remain tentative. The concluding religious language is transcribed as the poem's statement of faith.

Scan 057 10-057

"Things I Love": beauty in ordinary places

10-057-P01 65

Who will not pause to note the bliss
 That springs from raptured scenes *[[ideal?]]*
 Is dead to all that's dear,
 In vain the seasons may return

The Poles may freeze and Tropics *[[burn?]]*
 Alike to him the year,
 The flowers which strew the prairies green
 May make a mute appeal
 The Choral grove,—the Sylvan Scene
 All—cannot make him feel,
 But still can I each rapture Spy,
 That springs on plain or spray;
 And love them still, with earnest will
 The gentle and the gay.

10-057-P02 However humble is the Scene,
 I'm sure a raptured thrill *[[has been?]]*
 Down there awhile to stay,
 I'll gather then the nameless sweet
 From out each lone obscure *[[retreat?]]*
 Half hidden from the day,
 For still the mead and mountains brow
 Their varied beauties *[[yield?]]*,—
 The Summer's bloom, and Winter's snow
 Still give me joys annealed,
 With eager grasp, each one I clasp,
 With grateful throbbing heart
 I love them all, the great and *[[small?]]*
 The rapture giving part.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 65 is the middle page of “Things I Love”: read 10-054, 10-057, 10-056. Faded ends of lines remain marked rather than filled solely from rhyme. “Annealed” is the visible source word. The difficult phrase following “raptured thrill” is a tentative reading, not a reconstructed line.

Scan 058 10-058

“Apostrophe to the Brazos”: companionship and remembrance

10-058-P01 62

And yield ourselves unto the gentle wile
 That bids the cares of day so quick *[[depart?]]*
 With all their load of human hate and guile
 And leave untrammelled once our nobler part
 Where reigns supreme the sweeter passions of the heart.

10-058-P02 Delightful then it is at eve to stray
 Along yon rocky mountains wooded brow
 And while the pleasant sunny hours away
 In Social converse—whose influence now
 Is felt with all the charms of life I know,
 Of *[[illegible]]* Life, *[[deleted: that]]* *[[inserted: which]]* shared by one dear friend
 As *[[illegible]]* on that aged Live Oak bough

Esteem and confidence alike did blend
While Youth and Hope stood by, their mutual charm to lend.

10-058-P03 Around, were spread thy own eternal hills
All garlanded with wreaths of fadeless green
Amid whose bowers the mock-birds' gentle *[[trills?]]*
Awakened thoughts of things which "might have been,
Below, thy winding vallies fair were seen
Tilled by the sturdy ploughman's ready hand,,
The rustic cot, there humbly crowned the scene,
The poor man's home—his tender darling band
The dearest tie of all, in every patriots Land.

10-058-P04 These scenes, these thoughts awake and we forget
The Indian's grave, the white man's Sepulchre,
They lived and loved and hoped and toiled—but yet
Death came and severed all those ties so dear
Which bound them unto life, And *[[illegible]]*
Idly listless, above their venerated dust
And desecrate the tombs Affections' tear
Have reared to consecrate and guard the just
Against the tooth of Time, or dark Oblivion's rust.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 62 continues page 61 at 10-059 and precedes page 63 at 10-055. Several pale phrases remain unresolved. The poem's Indigenous imagery and generalized historical claims are preserved as literary content, not archaeological evidence or verified local history.

Scan 059 10-059

"Apostrophe to the Brazos"

10-059-P01 61
Apostrophe To the Brazos.

10-059-P02 Sweet Brazos! Still thy murmuring waters lave
Thy pebbly strand beneath yon Mountain height
Whose summit crowned by an ancient Indian *[[inserted: grave]]*
At once his nation's pride and nation's might,
Some hundred years have winged their weary flight
Since he was laid within the warriors tomb
O! what a change hath been! What withering blight
Has stamped the red man with an early doom—
And swept him from the earth, to give the pale face room.

10-059-P03 But still thou flowest on as in days of yore
With the same old tones, within thy Rocky bed
The rugged cliffs still crown thy winding shore—
Perchance an aged tree still rears its head;
And saving these, all *[[other?]]* Scenes have fled,
The Warrior proud and strong—his dusky Bride

The stalwart Chief—and trusted Steed—are dead
 The Wigwam gone—with all the Red Man's pride
 Swept with the flying years, *[[illegible]]* from their changeful tide.

10-059-P04 Though these are gone, still hearts as fondly brave
 And deeply true, still beat along thy stream,
 As those, thy long gone primal ages gave,
 Unto the world, and still as *[[vainly?]]* dream
 Of Love and Happiness, and fondly deem
 That they in after years will grasp the wand
 Of Human Bliss, whose rich illusive gleam
 Seen from afar but vainly leads them on
 Till Youth and health and strength and hope and life are gone.

10-059-P05 Tho' this be so, O! still we'll grasp the hour
 That beams with Love and Hope's illusive smile
 We'll woo its presence, and its cheerful power
 To be around us, tho' for so short awhile

Editorial note. Manuscript page 61. Read 10-059, 10-058, 10-055 (manuscript pages 61–63); the conclusion is dated June 1874. "Grave" is inserted above the first stanza. The poem imagines an Indigenous grave and presents a nineteenth-century narrative of Indigenous disappearance. Neither the grave's identity or age nor the claim of disappearance is independently established by this poem. No tribal identity or precise landmark is supplied.

Scan 060 10-060

"On the Banks of Brushy": twilight and remembered youth

10-060-P01 15

Thus still those early scenes which first I knew
 Linger on the pages of the shadowy Past
 Which as Memory turns its leaves comes to view
 In pure unstained colors, which will last
 When the bands of Age are round me cast
 And earthly joys grow dim and fade away
 And Life's last sands are ebbing fast
 And soon to mingle with earth's common clay
 Where all at last must moulder and decay.

10-060-P02 How beautiful! when the garish day was done
 The sky appeared in twilight's lovely hue
 When the last lingering rays of the glorious sun
 With amber streaked the deep heavenly blue
 Unto my boyish eyes the glorious view
 Seemed but the portals of a heaven on high
 Where from the horizon we might spring through
 And taste immortal bliss above the sky
 With those pure Spirits there which never die.

10-060-P03 And as still deeper glowed the tints of night
 Upon that horizon's far distant west.

The stars came forth with their lovely light
 And gazed on the earth like Spirits blest
 Watching it whilst it calmly sank to rest
 From the toil and cares of days passed here
 Whose fierce pursuits, pursued with eager zest
 By men, seeking for some altitude of power
 To dispense to mankind, curses by the hour.

10-060-P04 How softly falls, with the calm advance of night
 Its mild influences on mans stormy soul!
 Erasing the stripes of day, and bearing *[[unsought?]]*
 That boon of Heaven, whose high goal

Editorial note. Manuscript page 15 is displaced in the PDF. Read 10-050, 10-051, 10-060, 10-061, 10-052, 10-053 for manuscript pages 13–18. “Stripes” is retained in the final stanza; the last word of that line is uncertain. The final stanza continues at 10-061.

Scan 061 10-061

“On the Banks of Brushy”: childhood sleep and mortality

10-061-P01 16

Is fixed where Time’s billows can never roll
 Nor reach with their canker and decay
 The immortal Spirit’s far magnetic pole
 Around which it pursues its eternal way
 In the boundless light of an unending day.

10-061-P02 At length when all without was calm and still
 I would seek in slumber deep for childhood’s dream
 Softly lulled to sleep by the lone whip-poor-will
 Which sang its sweet song in nights soft beams
 And which to my young imaginations seems
 A lovely creature sent with pure nameless charms
 And matchless beauty, which in the starlight gleams
 Brilliant and bright, such as mightily warms
 A poets fancy when wrapped in Morpheus’ arms.

10-061-P03 How quiet are childhood’s slumbers! how free from all
 The stormy dreams of manhood’s feverish sleep!
 No wild unrest, no vain ambitions lofty fall!
 No withering hopes! o’er which to wake and weep
 But all is peace, and soft repose—and sweetly keep
 Their star watch o’er the young and tender frame
 Now resting in sweet unconsciousness so deep,
 That ’twere a pity, it should ever wake to claim
 A place again on the rough road to earthly Fame.

10-061-P04 Oh! it were better far in our earliest days
 Before we learn the torturing way of Sin,

That in Death, should be quenched Life's loved bright rays
 And we, sink into the tomb—though cold within
 Should be its cold vault—yet Oh! 'tis there
 Through that drear portal, and break the chain
 Of icy bondage there—and triumphing in
 The death struggle—returned unto Heaven again
 Resting the bliss of victory and Death of pain.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 16 follows 10-060 and precedes 10-052. This locates the two manuscript pages displaced from the poem's earlier scan sequence. The closing stanza is syntactically difficult; its words and line divisions are preserved without rewriting the archival text into smoother theology. The final phrase appears to be "Resting the bliss," not silently changed to "Tasting."

Scan 062 10-062

Poetry notebook: contents list

10-062-P01 *[[separate block: preprinted form]]*

OF _____ C. S. ARMY.

DESCRIPTION.

HEIGHT. Feet. In. | COMPLEXION | EYES | HAIR | WHERE BORN. Town or County. State. |

REMARKS.

10-062-P02 *[[separate block: handwritten contents list]]*

To Miss M. L. G. 5

To Miss M. L. G. 9

Idle Hours *[[deleted: illegible number]]* 39

[[illegible]] 12

[[Sonnet?]] [[illegible]] [[illegible number]]

Definition of Love 62

[[illegible: faint entry]]

To the Y. L. of the L. S. 18

Sonnet 14

Idle Hours 37

"Home" 14

To Miss M. A. A. 54

To W. H. *[[Bunn?]]* Esq. 16

To Miss M. L. G. 40

Idle Hours 31

A Visit to Siloam 58

To Miss M. A. A. 22

To The Same 24

To Miss Mat. A. 63

Idle Hours 39–52

On the death of B. D. Andrews—44

Varying Moments 48

For an Album 21

For an Album 20

Editorial note. The list is written over an unfilled printed Confederate Army descriptive-roll form. The numbers are notebook references, not scan-page identifiers. Several titles are repeated. Some faint entries and the surname before “Esq.” remain uncertain. The printed form headings do not describe the people named in the literary contents list.

Scan 063 10-063

“Convivial Journal,” 1866–1867

10-063-P01 3

[[separate block: preprinted descriptive-roll headings, as at 10-062]]

10-063-P02 Convivial Journal Jan 1866

1st E. M. Sears—H. G.¹ O.—A.² L. O.—J.³ N. O.—R.⁴ E. O.—G.⁵ O.—J. W.⁶ O.
R.⁶ N. A.—D.⁸ G.—*[[D.⁹ E. A. ?]]*—J. W.² R.—M.¹¹ E.—G.¹² R.—A.¹³ C.—T.¹⁴ L.—
R.¹⁵ C.—L.¹⁶ G.—C.¹⁷ C. B.—M.¹⁸ B.—M.¹⁹ B.—M.³ A. A.—M.⁴ A.—E.⁵ C. M.⁶ L. G.
E.⁷ C.—A.⁸ S. A.⁹ D.—S.¹⁰ G.—

[[9th?]] Wm A.—T. L.—H.² Met.—A.³ L. O.—R.⁴ E. O.—J.⁵ N. O.—G.⁶ O.—J.⁷ W. O.—
J. & W.⁸ O.—R.⁹ E. O.—E.¹⁰ E. A.—D.¹¹ G.—J.¹² G.—S.¹³ B.—J.¹⁴ W. R.—J.¹⁵ D.—
B.¹⁶ B.—B.¹⁷ S.—G.¹⁸ C.—J.¹⁹ G.—J.²⁰ T.—L.²¹ P.—W.²² T.—
L.¹ G.—M.² A. A.—M.³ A.—G.⁴ M.—E.⁵ P.—M.⁶ C.—L.⁷ C.—*[[illegible]]*

W.¹⁴ H.—M.¹¹ L. G.—

11th J. M. *[[B. L. ?]]*—J. W. R.—D. D. B. R. R.—D. D. O.—H. G. O.—J. N. O.—B. G. E.—L. D.—
M. G. A.—G. D.—E. E. D.—J. P. B.—M. L. B.—

[[separate block: note at right]]

[[D.² E. A. ?]]

D. & D. *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]]

[[separate block: journal continues]]

16 At *[[illegible]]*—G. D. *[[illegible]]* Geo *[[illegible]]* Wm—

L. C. M. *[[illegible]]* Ed. E. R.—

20th *[[Joseph?]]* B. L. *[[illegible]]* *[[Tom?]]* *[[illegible]]* Geo *[[illegible]]*

[[illegible]] Wm *[[illegible]]* Ed *[[illegible]]* *[[Nipp?]]* & Neck—

10-063-P03 June 1866

Henry Andrews—*[[illegible]]*—*[[illegible]]*

10-063-P04 January 1867

1st At J. H. A. McKnight’s with R. L. O. H. W. T. M. B. *[[illegible]]*

[[Sandy?]]—Wm C. Em. L. Em. M. A. A. present—

Editorial note. An independent partial reading of a journal written on a reused military form. The page is dark and several names and letter sequences are unclear. Superscript numbers occur within the lists; their purpose is not explained, so they are retained without converting them into ages, quantities, or dates. No full names are supplied for initials. The January 1866 lists and later entries need further manuscript review.

Scan 064 10-064

Brief journal entries, August and September 1866

10-064-P01 *[[separate block: preprinted form]]*

DESCRIPTIVE ROLL OF COMMISSIONED OFFICERS, COMPANY, ()

RANK. | NAME. | DATE OF ELECTION OR APPOINTMENT. | DATE OF PROMOTION. | RANK OF PROMOTION. | AGE. | OCCUPATION.

10-064-P02 August *[[30th?]]* 1866. *[[Having?]]* *[[illegible]]* Cousin Mollie present and threatens to write me *[[illegible]]*

To save my *[[life?]]* in *[[that?]]* case *[[illegible]]*
[[illegible: several faint lines]]

10-064-P03 Sept 20th A small chunk of a wedding at *[[Greenwood?]]* which passed off very well considering the bad weather.

The first norther of the season being introduced made things a little cool as well as comfortable

Editorial note. Dark scan of another reused printed military form. Most of the August entry is too faint for a dependable full reading; it mentions “Cousin Mollie.” The September entry describes a wedding and the season’s first norther, a cold wind, but the place name remains tentative. Neither the marrying couple nor the diarist is identified on this page.

Scan 065 10-065

To Miss M. L. G.: courtship after peace returns

10-065-P01 5

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form, as at 10-062]]

To Miss M. L. G.....

10-065-P02 Now gentle peace has come again

And every girl wants a man

And every man is in a whirl

Looking around for a girl

Who is to share his after life

As his companion—partner—wife—

And all is bustle and confusion

Around Hymen’s bower—and the allusion,

To anything that ties up two

For life in bonds enduring

In a young chap will never do

That is if he is not a “daring.”

10-065-P03 But as each one has some choice above

The ordinary feelings of his mind

I sincerely think the “Elm Grove”

Will fill the Ideal to which I’m inclined.

And I do intend to win

The prize that there is glowing

But doubtless I’ll have opposition in

My endeavors at so doing.

I know of but only four

Who stand opposed to my endeavors

Yet they may puzzle me quite sore

As, They are gentlemanly and clever,

I will mention them in detail
 And pardon any digression
 That may occur in manner metrical
 For this is an allowed transgression.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 5, on a reused military form. Continues through 10-066–10-068, ending with a May 1, 1866 date. “Elm Grove” and the four rivals’ labels are left as the poem presents them; no identities or modern place locations are inferred. Hymen’s bower is an image of marriage. The light, competitive rhetoric does not establish actual engagements.

Scan 066 10-066

To Miss M. L. G.: the rivals “Elysian,” “Bloomdale,” and “Shiloh”

10-066-P01 6

[[separate block: preprinted form]]

DESCRIPTIVE ROLL OF NON-COMMISSIONED OFFICERS, COMPANY, ()

No | NAME | AGE | ENLISTMENT. WHEN. WHERE. BY WHOM. TERM. | OCCUPATION.

10-066-P02 “Elysian’s” claims are old and strong
 And await you there a splendid bower
 Which you may enjoy ere long
 As a patrimonial dower.
 But I candidly believe
 The owner will never do
 For verily he will deceive
 Others, and why not you
 His claims I’ll admit are old enough
 To hold the prize if true enough
 But their constancy I doubt
 Since I’ve heard the idle chat’s out
 In circulation round about.

10-066-P03 “Bloomdale” has found a voice to speak
 And oft quite oft I hear it squeak;
 I fear it not for subtle wit
 But once it grasps ’twill never quit
 Its hold upon the object sought.
 Until the prize is fairly caught.
 But there are so many “ifs” and “ans”
 And “I’ll come it if I can”
 “But when and where to show my love
 “I know not or how it to prove
 “So as to win the prize of ‘Elm Grove,’

10-066-P04 From “Shiloh” loud at times there comes
 A brave and beauteous boy
 Who to my heart “strikes terror dumb”
 And threats to mar for aye my joy.
 Oh! that Time’s devouring shafts may fall

Editorial note. Manuscript page 6 follows 10-065 and continues at 10-067. The names in quotation marks function as the poem's labels. The charge of deception against a rival and references to gossip are literary claims, not verified conduct. "Ans" is reproduced as written, apparently a shortened "ands."

Scan 067 10-067

To Miss M. L. G.: mock curses and a fourth rival

10-067-P01 7

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form, as at 10-062]]

Upon his glowing face!

In Showers thick fast and terrible

And destroy each lovely trace

Of feature that now glowing shines

And leave him halt, lame, sick, unsoond,

With all those woes which swift refines

The failing body for the ground,

Because he leaves his home to mar the joys

Of other and of better boys

Who claim by right the first choice

Of all the maids of syren voice

Who dwell around in the country near

And are to me so very dear

And I can them all in detail love

But best of all the prize of "Elm Grove,"

10-067-P02 "Seclusion" too will put in his claim

From his hermitted bowers.

They will get—howies but in name

So I care not for their powers.

Perhaps howies as he damns all

Who fill not his Ideal

His maledictions he may let fall

Upon this glorious rival.

Just let them come and if your feelings

Are wounded by his rough opinion

"His muddy head I'll be after peeling"

Just as a paddy would an onion.

10-067-P03 Yes fly to me, thou dearest maid

And protection I will give,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 7 follows 10-066 and continues at 10-068. "Unsoond" and "howies" are retained as visible nonstandard forms; the precise sense of "howies" is unclear. The extravagant curses and threat are part of a comic rivalry poem, not evidence that a physical attack occurred. "Paddy" is the source's dated ethnic stereotype.

Scan 068 10-068

To Miss M. L. G., May 1, 1866; four epigrams

10-068-P01 8

[[separate block: preprinted descriptive roll and enlistment headings, as at 10-066, with troop category blank]]

Until this form is lowly laid
And I shall cease to live
Enshrined within my heart for aye
Your image shall ever sit
So will you not come and stay
Forever there with it.

10-068-P02 My misery is complete on earth
Alone as I am living
My life is a very death
To me no pleasure giving.
Shortly then I know I'll die
Because no one will me love
The reason I cannot tell why,
Can you fair maid of "Elm Grove"

10-068-P03 I loved you at first and now still better
And love you I ever will
This you may see by my letter
Can you love a Verdant Hill?

10-068-P04 May 1st 1866

10-068-P05 *[[separate block: Epigrams, lower left column]]*

Epigrams.
If you wish to get a new wrinkle
Upon your brow deeply set
Go over and note the Rip van winkle
There is in Liberty etiquette.

10-068-P06 A prayer meeting "is the chief concern"
As every sinner knows
By which he can most quietly learn
How he stands at uncle *[[Gid's?]]*,

10-068-P07 *[[separate block: Epigrams, lower right column]]*

If you want to get any information
From any Liberty aboriginal
Don't go to the composition examination
For *[[Ben?]]* will tell you they are original,

10-068-P08 People often go to a frolic or ball,
To seek for enjoyment in general

But there you will find that one and all
For amusement will go to a funeral,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 8 concludes 10-065–10-067. The final question is underlined. “Verdant Hill” may be a joking designation or persona; no real identity is assigned. Four separate epigrams occupy the lower part of the page in two columns. Their jokes about Liberty, prayer meetings, compositions, and funerals are reproduced as satire, not as a verified description of a community. Two names remain tentative.

Scan 069 10-069

To Miss M. L. G.: a reply about the anonymous verses

10-069-P01 9

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form, as at 10-062]]

To Miss M. L. G.....

10-069-P02 'Tis all in vain you strive and try
And glance about so furtively
And eye each boy that comes in sight
As though 'twas he that did indite
Unto you these Scattering rhymes
Flung out offhand in backwoods chimes
In which was made such abrupt allusion
To “Elysian” “Bloomdale” *[[inserted: “Shiloh”]]* and “Seclusion,”
And told upon them some very ugly tales
No doubt which made them think they are not whales.

10-069-P03 No doubt “Elysian” calls it an outrage
Upon a gentleman of his age
And makes him loudly rave and storm
Against a poor unknown fellow worm.

10-069-P04 “Bloomdale” no doubt will cut a figure
Erect his brows and feel the bigger
Simply because I took the notion
To make some slight notices of him.

10-069-P05 “Shiloh” no doubt will never know
Who has caused him so much woe
But should the three get together
Lift their heads and raise their feathers
And strut about as big as Aristotle
Having along a big black bottle
Should they then this mortal chance to see
What! oh what!! would become of poor me!
Continued on Page 53

Editorial note. Manuscript page 9 refers back to the rivals in 10-065–10-068. “Shiloh” is inserted above the line listing them. The page explicitly directs the reader to manuscript page 53 for its continuation. The speaker presents himself as unknown; this is not an author’s signature. “Whales” is retained as written. The continuation has been located at 10-093–10-096 (manuscript pages 33–36); 10-093 explicitly says “Continued from 9th page.” The forward reference here was read as 53 and is retained pending closer numeral comparison.

Scan 070 10-070

"Social Parties—What Are They?": a critical account of local gatherings

10-070-P01 10

[[separate block: preprinted descriptive roll and enlistment headings, as at 10-068]]

Social Parties—What Are They?

10-070-P02 The Social Parties as practiced by the Native and Adopted citizens of the younger class in this Section are in my humble opinion the most ridiculous amusements which it is possible for intelligent people to practice. Imagine a gathering of thirty or forty young people aged respectively from eighteen to thirty at some place selected for the contemplated performance. Having met and sat about rather indolently for awhile apparently very much embarrassed and seemingly very modest and very fearful of doing something contrary to the rules of Etiquette some venturesome character proposes a "play" The young gents capering select their partners and ere long promenading the floor in a circle by twos to the bewitching strains of "Old Sister Phebe" or "My pretty little love" or some other popular air sung in enchanting style by some one or two vocalists. No conversation worthy the name is ever carried on by any couple, those not engaged in singing keep profoundly silent or indulge in unmeasured laughter at some real or imaginary blunders of some one or more of the party. Tiring of the first or any other play each individual looks for a seat for him or herself, or a drink of water or something else. The girls congregate on one side of the house and indulge in apparently very lively and interesting chat if we are to judge from the many Smiling faces and little giggles which may from time

Editorial note. Manuscript page 10 continues at 10-071. This is the writer's satirical criticism, not a neutral survey. The location and date become explicit on the following page: Ellis County, Texas, May 1866. "Native and Adopted citizens" here distinguishes local-born residents and newcomers in the writer's wording; it is not an identification of Indigenous ancestry. Song titles are transcribed, not attributed to an external version.

Scan 071 10-071

"Social Parties": Ellis County, Texas, May 1866

10-071-P01 11

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form, as at 10-062]]

to time be seen and heard. Poor things how they appear to enjoy themselves when alone but let a venturesome young Swain invade their circle an immediate Silence succeeds which generally makes a fellow feel as though he might have been the subject of the previous amusement and merriment. Thus the evening wears away varied by all the silly singing little plays with which the performers are acquainted until all get tired and break up by common consent. Each Swain takes his Sweetheart home if he has one and those who have none go home alone as *[[illegible]]*. Such is society in Ellis county Texas May 1866. Such is the manner in which the young deport themselves one toward another. What the Legitimate result of all this may be I have no way of determining it is to be hoped however that it will terminate in something more refined as well as Sensible And that a higher degree of Sociability may be attained than is at present *[[afforded?]]*.

10-071-P02 Something loftier should be adopted for all confess when the point is urged that they feel ashamed of themselves *[[when?]]* participating in Such silly amusements. Then why not at once do away *[[with?]]* them and adopt something in their stead of which we will not be ashamed. Common sense could suggest many convenient ways of amusement which would be *[[profitable as well as agreeable?]]*.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 11 concludes the essay begun at 10-070. A few faded phrases, especially at the bottom, remain uncertain. The place and month-year are explicit. Broad claims about everyone's behavior or feelings are the writer's judgments and are not independently established.

Scan 072 10-072

A Fourth of July school exhibition near Red Oak in 1866

10-072-P01 12

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

July 4th 1866—Was spent at Mrs *[[Ray's?]]* School—

Examination one and a half miles *[[deleted: west]]*

West of Red Oak post office

10-072-P02 'Twas a brilliant affair for Texas at this stage of its intellectual development. Surpassing anything of the kind which has occurred so far in the history of this section of country. Nothing however Original spoken or performed on the stage, all derived from the brain of some foreign Genius.

10-072-P03 Eleven o'clock at night closed the fleeting pageantry and all I suppose went home satisfied judging from outside appearances—and some are doubtless delighted arguing from the same reason—but we have no right I suppose to surmise the secret history of any of the many palpitating fatty hearts that left that ground—if one did perhaps all that might be told would not be pleasant to hear.

10-072-P04 In common parlance the "Skirmish Line" was established & at least one Hymeneal affair was fully accomplished on this occasion of wit *[[mirth?]]*—May all at last leave all parties satisfied and happy and content to go on their way rejoicing—if not from the full fruition of their hopes and anticipations at least in the hope of a better day coming when they can at least call the *[[beloved?]]* *[[illegible]]* their own, if only Temporarily. *[[deleted: illegible]]* Sunshine and Shadow are strangely commingled in this *[[mundane?]]* Sphere. Those who are gay today may *[[be sad?]]* tomorrow, and those who are sad today may be gay tomorrow. It is doubtless *[[more pleasant?]]* to watch these transitions than to *[[undergo?]]* them—We will wait awhile and *[[illegible]]*.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 12. School proprietor's surname and several faded words remain uncertain. An "examination" here includes a public stage exhibition. The writer's "Hymeneal affair" refers to a romantic or marital connection but does not identify a couple or independently establish a wedding. The final lines are washed out.

Scan 073 10-073

Sixteen years in Ellis County and the difficulties of farming

10-073-P01 13

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

A residence of Sixteen years in this portion of Texas (Ellis County) has not made me fall in love with it by any means. 'Tis may be the easiest place to "get along" in of any other—yet the experience which I have had here in common farming life forces me to the conclusion that it is a hard place to make a living. The general mildness of the climate, and *[[slowness?]]* of the Summer have enervated the inhabitants to such a degree that they do not look forward with the proper foresight in regard to their pecuniary interests. Proper places for deposit of grain are not provided and frequently crops suffer *[[deleted: from]]* destruction to a considerable extent from this cause alone. We are poorly provided with machinery of all descriptions, There is not half mills enough in the country consequently instead of Competition we have Combination, and exorbitant rates of toll are charged which is detrimental to the farming interests of the country, but we farmers have to submit to an *[[illegible]]* which we cannot help and any hope

[[illegible]] away change. I cite Millers [[illegible]] which [[inflict?]] upon the Community—Other professions do likewise as far as they are able. Self is the governing principle here [[to?]] the exclusion of all other and [[while?]] [[illegible]] [[localities?]] whose competition gives the farming class a chance to realize the full value of their crops from year to year [[would?]] surely be more desirable than [[illegible]] they are much the most [[illegible]].

Editorial note. Manuscript page 13 is unsigned and undated. The preceding page is dated July 4, 1866; this does not establish this page's date or author. Sixteen years is an explicit statement, but a circa-1850 arrival would be an inference contingent on dating and identification. The writer's opinions about climate, inhabitants and millers are not independently verified. The lower portion is faded and several connecting clauses remain unreadable.

Scan 074 10-074

Home and the ties of childhood

10-074-P01 14

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Home

10-074-P02 There are many pleasant associations connected with the word Home, It embodies at one group and in one view the leading features of our earlier days. Our first recollections, our first associations our first connections all spring at once to the mind at the mention of that one word. Our recollections of the innocent Sports that beguiled the days of our infancy, when lighthearted and joyous we played amid Sunshine and flowers, inhaling the wild free air and Spirit of nature, careless and gay as the bright plumaged birds which warbled their hymns of praise from every tree, Free as they from the follies and vices of the world nor dreaming of the blight of after years through which we would be called to pass—Our earlier associations with companions joyous as we, which can never be renewed, but which will linger in Memory, as one of the brightest periods of our existence; and to which we can always turn with pleasing emotions—Our earlier connections with parents, brothers, and sisters, fond endearing ties, woven in childhood years, and never to be forgotten, though separated by time and distance, far from the places where they sprung into existence—These remembrances all spring within the mind when Home is mentioned and as we contemplate them through the lapse of years they assume a hallowed purity, which no other scenes or associations can. They are holy because they belong to the past, they are sacred because they are pure and uncontaminated by vile connections, they are the tender ties of early love, mutually enjoyed and mutually reciprocated, they are the holy links which bind the family

Editorial note. Manuscript page 14 continues at 10-075. This is a general reflection, not a list of the writer's own identified relatives. The following page says it was written at a young lady's request at Seclusion, September 20, 1866.

Scan 075 10-075

The conclusion of Home and a sonnet on vanished hopes

10-075-P01 15

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

band together in bonds of perpetual union.

The influence of such associations will always be felt no matter what may be our course through life, whether wild and dissipated, or gentle and refined, in one case, they will check us in our wayward career, and point to a nobler existence, in the other, they will be an incentive to a continuation in a life of well doing, ennobling our feelings and refining our natures, inspiring in our hearts a spirit of Charity and

contentment which will be a perpetual wellspring of happiness to us, which the cares of Life cannot destroy.

Written at the request of a Young Lady
Seclusion Sept 20th 1866.

10-075-P02 Sonnet or, Blent Flowers,
Adieu ye bright hopes that so fondly have hovered
Around the light dreams of my earlier days
When with feelings transparent and affections uncovered
I faced the gay world in its meridian blaze
Those visions of joy bright *[[deleted: in]]* *[[inserted: all]]* ecstatic Elysian
Have faded before adversity's cold gaze
And nought now remains but those dreams *[[deleted: of]]* *[[inserted: Life's elysion]]*
Dimly discovered through memory's dark haze
But still they will linger on those dim distant pages
And occasionally be read when a sunbeam there strays
And fondly remembered as one of those happy ages
That in Childhood and Youth deceivingly plays
But will return not again in life's varied stages
Although we hope for it in Philosophy's atherian ways
Seclusion July 1866

Editorial note. Manuscript page 15 concludes "Home" at 10-074, dated Seclusion, September 20, 1866. A separate sonnet is dated Seclusion, July 1866. The sonnet's unusual words "elysion" and "atherian" are retained as read; the revised seventh line is syntactically awkward. "Blent Flowers" is the title as read. Seclusion is not expanded into a geographic identification.

Scan 076 10-076

To W H B on lasting friendship

10-076-P01 16

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

To W. H. B.....

10-076-P02 Though short the time since first we met
The few bright and glowing scenes
That have past I can never forget
While I know what pleasure means.
But to those moments sweetly fraught
That yielded such a pleasant time
I would bestow a passing thought
Penned in idle Scattering rhyme.

10-076-P03 To Friendship I would dedicate my verse
(That brightly blooms in darkest hours)
And though it may be rude and coarse
A nobler aim shall direct its powers.

10-076-P04 May the friendship we have just begun
Stand the test of after years

“And round our hearts be surely spun”

The chains that pleasure fondly bears,

10-076-P05 True Friendship like the gnarled Oak

Firm rooted in the rock

Feel the lightnings deadliest Stroke

And brave the tempests rudest shock,

But when the moaning storms are sped,

And calmly comes the hour of even—

Again it rears its vernal head

Towards the ether vault of Heaven,

10-076-P06 Be it ours to brave the lightnings brand

Of malice dark and dread,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 16 continues at 10-077, where it is signed Geo. Douglas and dated November 18, 1866. The recipient is given here only by initials. The printed form is reused stationery, not a completed enlistment record.

Scan 077 10-077

George Douglas on friendship and a later farewell verse

10-077-P01 17

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Be it ours to firmly rooted stand

While calumnys storms burst overhead

So when the storms of Life are past

And their fury spent that was given

Friendship will point our way at last

Toward the upper courts of Heaven,

10-077-P02 Thus I give to friendship true

Words that can never be lost

Which will be highly prized by you

While you remain at Honors post,

And if you should ever be forsaken

By Loves circle false and fair

Olden emotions will awaken

When you read what I have written here.

Geo. Douglas

Seclusion Nov 18th 1866

10-077-P03 *[[separate block: separate farewell verse]]*

Farewell for now my eyes wax dim,

And I must leave this home so blest

But where I'm gone my thoughts will ever

And on dear *[[Matty?]]* Farm alight

For 'tis in this secluded spot

That tranquil hours have passed,

Peace to the *[[hearts?]]* whose happy lot
 On earth with thee are cast.
 June 27th 1869
[[L?]]

Editorial note. Manuscript page 17 concludes 10-076. The signature Geo. Douglas and date Seclusion, November 18, 1866 are explicit. A separate verse below is dated June 27, 1869, with a short initial-like mark. Its third line ends “ever” without a clear following verb; this is retained. The farm name and “hearts” remain uncertain.

Scan 078 10-078

To the Y L of the L S or the gnawing of a bone

10-078-P01 18

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

To the Y. L. of the L. S.
 (Or the gnawing of a bone)

10-078-P02 Now gentle girls polite and fair
 As I am tonight all alone
 I will try and get off some rhyming ware
 About a tough and crusty bone.

10-078-P03 I am told you have a bone to gnaw
 Harder than any heretofore known
 The like of it nobody ever saw
 It is such a very strange bone.

10-078-P04 Every monday morning I understand
 All of your faults you have to own
 Then lay strong hold with both your hands
 And go to gnawing on this bone.

10-078-P05 Tewsday comes bright and fair
 Yet there is no softness shown
 And each moment you busy are
 Gnawing away upon this bone.

10-078-P06 So you go until Saturday
 The trying task all week youve known
 Yet you have not gnawed away
 One particle of this hard bone.

10-078-P07 Then comes the Sabbath pure and bright
 Its glories over earth are thrown

Editorial note. Manuscript page 18 begins a comic poem continued through 10-080, dated Seclusion, December 8, 1866. Initials are not expanded with certainty. The bone becomes an insult to a person in the final stanza; its gnawing imagery is figurative.

Scan 079 10-079

The strange bone and a joke about army food

10-079-P01 19

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Yet you have to take a double bite
Of this everlasting bone.

10-079-P02 I too have been biting something very tough
The like of it I have never known
'Tis neither smooth nor very rough
Possibly it may be your bone?

10-079-P03 When I used to be in the army
I ate everything to me thrown
For I knew it could not harm me
Although it was a dry bone.

10-079-P04 But I am not so sure about this
For it makes my teeth ache, I own,
And I do not like the bliss
There is in gnawing on this bone.

10-079-P05 'Tis different from anything I ever tried
Or anything I have ever known
So I will look over the world wide
To find a name for this bone.

10-079-P06 'Tis neither duck nor goose nor chick
Nor of no hog with fat oer grown
But something mighty hard and Slick
So I am sure it is a bone.

10-079-P07 'Tis not sheep nor deer nor horse
Nor anything in modern times grown
So I think as a matter of course

Editorial note. Manuscript page 19 continues 10-078; concludes at 10-080. The speaker says he was in the army, within a comic poem. This line alone does not identify an author or military unit.

Scan 080 10-080

The bone joke concluded and an album blessing

10-080-P01 20

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

It must be of Balaams animal a bone.

10-080-P02 So now you have my guess
(And for it I may groan)
So let us rig up a dress
To put upon our poor bone.

10-080-P03 I think it should have a just desert
 These cold and wintry weathers
 So I propose an overshirt
 Of genuine Tar and Feathers.
 Seclusion. Dec 8th 1866

10-080-P04 For an Album,
 To grace thy Albums virgin leaf
 From the depths of my soul I bring
 Some purer thought where Love is chief
 An unrestrained votive offering—
 I place upon thy Friendships shrine
 The heartfelt wish from on high
 That for you the brightest suns may shine
 And not a cloud oercast thy sky.
 May flowers along thy pathway bloom
 Of every hue which brightness yields
 And hourly shed their sweet perfumes
 From myriads of ambrosial fields,
 May Love and health and happiness
 Be thy lot wherever you go
 And you be shorn of loneliness
 And the *[[obscured: ink blot]]* flowing cup of woe.
 Feb 12 1867.
 Geo.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 20 concludes 10-078–10-079 with an allusion to Balaam’s animal and a proposal of tar and feathers. This is a satirical threat within verse, not evidence that an assault took place. A separate “For an Album” is dated February 12, 1867 and signed Geo. A blot obscures part of the final line.

Scan 081 10-081

An album poem on remembrance in sorrow

10-081-P01 21
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
 For an Album,

10-081-P02 To grace an Albums virgin page
 With thoughts and words both suited
 For youthful prime and manly age
 Is a task I have not mastered.

10-081-P03 But since it is I must appear
 With others here on Friendships scroll
 I hope I will not be held more dear
 If I should possess a deeper soul.

10-081-P04 I ask no place in affections name
 To remembrance when all is bright

For me it is too high a claim
To gayly seek with feelings light.

10-081-P05 But when to you is widely given
Anguish fierce and burning draught
And from your heart is rudely driven
Friends whose health youve freely quaffed.

10-081-P06 Oh! then remember one who loves
To *[[illegible]]* in *[[illegible]]* lie
One who through life careless roves
Nor breathes for others woes a sigh.
January 1867

Editorial note. Manuscript page 21. Part of the second line of the final stanza remains unreadable after enlargement. The last line reads "Nor breathes for others woes a sigh"; it is not silently reversed to make a conventionally sympathetic ending. No author or recipient is named.

Scan 082 10-082

To Miss M A A or fair Mary

10-082-P01 22
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
To Miss M. A. A.

10-082-P02 When Heavens blue arch so gracefully bending
Above me brightly glows with loves azure hue
And the mind with sweet thoughts calmly ascending
Along that bright arch turns fair Mary to you.

10-082-P03 As the needle with magnet faithfully thrilling
Still points to the pole so steady and true
So the deepest emotions of my hearts fond instilling
Drawn with true magnet fair Mary to you.

10-082-P04 And when on the green grassy banks reclining
Of fair Red Oak, listening to its waters flowing there
The entrancing shades, above it so gracefully entwining
Fond Memory turns fair Mary to you.

10-082-P05 The voices of waters songsters in those bowers dwellying
My wild restless Spirit does enchantingly woo
But still while I listen to the wild choral ringing
In rapture my heart turns fair Mary to you.

10-082-P06 And like the Sunflower its fair face Extending
In the early morn ere it sheds the bright dew
To meet the bold gaze of its bright god ascending
So I open my heart fair Mary to you.

10-082-P07 In the morning of Life I am now joyously standing
Before me is spread bright prospects sweet to view

With the gay Charm of Hope my heart is expanding
But they all point at last fair Mary to—you.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 22 continues through 10-084, where it is signed Geo. Douglas, Seclusion, October 15, 1866. Mary is named in the poem; her remaining initials are not expanded. “Red Oak” is named as a watercourse in the poem. Unusual syntax, such as “Drawn with true magnet,” is retained.

Scan 083 10-083

The plea for Mary's support

10-083-P01 23

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Linked with the future how fondly entwining
Are the tendrils of my heart around the lovely & True
And as the vine on the tree so confidently reclining
So my affections recline fair Mary on you.

10-083-P02 But can I claim for them that substantial supporting
The tree yields the vine succeeding years through
And be securely screened against Cynics rude sporting
May I ever hope for this fair Mary from you!

10-083-P03 While my cheek the soft wind of Autumn is fanning
And the forests have assumed the bright Sombre hue
While the beauties of nature I am rapturously scanning
Thought eagerly turns fair Mary to you.

10-083-P04 When the bright plumaged birds their harmony swelling
In soft thrilling notes through scattering and few
Then my hearts pure emotions deeply are swelling
To Nature's wild music fair Mary and you.

10-083-P05 And when o'er earth Twilights dusky mantle is spreading
And peacefully we gaze the sky's *[[inserted: deep]]* ether blue
Up that star spangled vault my thoughts are oft treading
And Fancy is weaving bright garlands for you.

10-083-P06 The treasures of the heart she is modestly wreathing
With the gems of the Soul that lend their bright hue
Over all the Spirit of Affection she's breathing
And Smilingly waves it fair Mary to you.

10-083-P07 That Spirits bright beam my soul is beholding
Imagery paints on it joys brighter far anew

Editorial note. Manuscript page 23 continues 10-082 and leads to 10-084. “Through scattering and few” is retained as written; it may have been intended as “though.” The closing two lines begin a stanza completed on the next page. The love and hope expressed belong to the speaker, not an established reciprocal relationship.

Scan 084 10-084

George Douglas's verses to Mary and To the Same

10-084-P01 24

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Its rapturous beauties are sweetly unfolding
Yielding their brightness fair Mary to—you.

10-084-P02 And still while its halo so beautifully beaming
With a soft lovely light so charming to view
My Soul is entranced with the visions so soft seeming
Yet breathes with devotion fair Mary to you.

10-084-P03 Now I yield on thy Shrine Friendships first brightling
'Tis an offering of Faith which is but due
A few simple lines my Soul's own inditing
From the depths of my heart fair Mary to you.

Geo. Douglas

Seclusion Oct 15th 1866

10-084-P04 To The Same,

10-084-P05 O'er the Orient sky the bright dawn is Streaming
Rousing Slumbering Nature from its dreamy repose
Through the forests there arises gaily so Screaming
The sweetest reveille from Minstrels gay foes
I spring from my couch—my visions bright seeming
Mingling with Natures in its reality true
Fading are the raptures of the last nights dreaming
Yet a deeper rapture awaits *[[inserted: me]]* fair Mary in you

10-084-P06 The Sun from his bed gloriously is Springing
And up the bright east triumphantly rides
O'er the wide earth his rays gayly he is flinging
That bows in his gaze the loveliest of brides
And the music of Nature, the hymn she is Singing

Editorial note. Manuscript page 24 concludes 10-082–10-083 with Geo. Douglas's signature and October 15, 1866 date. "Friendships first brightling" is retained. "To the Same" then begins and continues at 10-085. The unusual wording "Minstrels gay foes" is transcribed as read, without replacing it with a conjectural bird phrase.

Scan 085 10-085

Birdsong and a heavenly offering to Mary

10-085-P01 25

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

In fondest adoration devoted and true
And while I hear its wild melody ringing
Affection then points me fair Mary to you.

10-085-P02 In some distant bower I hear the soft cooing
 Of the ring dove as it so closely keeps
 Watch oer the bride of its hearts early wooing
 That dreamily on a neighboring bough sleeps
 And I fancy it has not known the hearts deep unresting
 That afflicts us when we love the lovely and true
 And has never known the ranging hopes of pursuing
 As those I have felt fair Mary for you.

10-085-P03 Now the lark from *[[inserted: its]]* dewy nest widely Springing
 Soars far up on high oer the green coated plain
 And amid the blue heavens sweetly is Singing
 In the ear of its Maker natures wild strain,
 In his viewless wake, my Soul I am flinging
 Robed in a vesture of fair heavenly hue
 And with the “music of the Spheres” my Spirit is ringing
 Commingling their sweetness fair Mary for you.
 Nov 186*[[lost: remaining date at right edge]]*

10-085-P04 From Heavens high portals Angels are descending
 Bearing their harps of bright golden hue—
 To meet the bright host on Faiths wings ascending
 My Spirit traverses the Skys ether blue.
 Ten thousand voices in harmony blending
 Bequeathed me an offering beautiful and true
 Of Love in its brightness, all things Earthly, transcending
 And bade me bear it fair Mary to you.
 Jan 27–1867

Editorial note. Manuscript page 25 continues “To the Same” from 10-084. A date at the right edge reads Nov 186 followed by loss; it is not completed conjecturally. The following stanza has the separate date January 27, 1867. Some unusual phrasing, including “ranging hopes,” is retained.

Scan 086 10-086

Dutch Campmeeting in September 1866

10-086-P01 26

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Dutch Campmeeting 1866.

In 1866 in September

I went to the campmeeting

And as well as I can remember

Received a very cordial greeting

The first of social joys which I took

Was a gentle sprinkling.

Thus I caught a forward look

And of what was coming got an inkling.

’Twas rain a shower and mud a heap

And drabbled dresses plenty
 And I got many a sly peep
 At tapering ankles from ten to twenty.
 The camp accommodations were very poor
 And it did not suit the lasses
 To have to sit upon the floor
 On straw in lieu of grasses.
 Grasses they would have preferred beneath a willow
 Soft yielding green dewy sparkling ever
 And every lass of them a handsome fellow
 To twain bright garland posies weaving ever
 But alas! the difference, a preacher here
 Restraining the free flow of chat
 Between the gents and ladies fair
 A thing they all would fain be at.
 But after a while they bolder grew
 And some got in the passage
 And what do ye think they did do
 When they got the passage?
 Why they mixed all up together
 In a crowd huddle—

Editorial note. Manuscript page 26 begins a long satirical poem continued through 10-090. “To twain bright garland posies weaving ever” is unusual wording retained as read. The social and physical descriptions are the speaker’s often unkind judgments. This verse should not be treated as a verified report about identifiable people.

Scan 087 10-087

Camp meeting conversation and flirtation

10-087-P01 27

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

And did not mind a bit the weather
 Falling rain or Splashing puddle.
 And now and then a softer word
 I spect was slyly thrown in
 And by the proper person heard
 Who never thought it a bit o’ sin.
 But this I do not know
 I only simply guess it
 But they had none to do
 A great deal in the way of chat
 Betimes they grew more confidential
 As they got into a livelier mood
 And some things were said potential
 Which by the way were very good.
 But I did not like the stile of compliments
 Which was peped around off from the fence

Yet I do not think any one meant
To give to any other any offence.

10-087-P02 There was a brace of widows there
Some ugly and very fat
They could hardly lay claim to being fair
Unless 'twas to that which was past
They eyed the boys and could talk
Upon a string peculiarly their own
Yet they could sit about or take a walk
And be the while entirely alone.
And then there was the handsome young misses
[[Gagging?]] about just in their teens
All made up for glorious hugs and kisses
Which a fellow might get on the sly I ween

Editorial note. Manuscript page 27 continues 10-086 and leads to 10-088. Unusual syntax and “peped” are retained. The verb before “about” near the bottom is uncertain. Derogatory descriptions of widows and young women are the writer’s language, not editorial judgments.

Scan 088 10-088

The camp meeting poem on flattery and courtship

10-088-P01 28
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
How affectionate they looked so coy and sly
With their bright eyes glancing about
Seeming to say “if you will but try
The kisses you may have with a pout!”
By hokey! the favorite young devil
Who was smart enough to get a few smacks
Should I find him in manner quite civil
I’ll endeavor to walk in his tracks!
I will be all smiles and attention
And specially notice their slightest needs
Do everything that politeness could mention
And think of all things that it cant.
And always with the greatest deference
Will I lift my hat when I speak to them
And always manifest the greatest preference
For any thing to which they take the whim.
To please them so in a loving mood
I will tell them lies by the score
And if this does not do any good
I will tell them twice as many more.
Then if I see their brows gently reproving
I will instantly recant all I have said
And be so affectionate and loving

They will bestow blessings by the forewarning head,
 In short I will bend as the willow
 To every slight breath of the wind
 And do everything in the world to pillow
 My head on their bosoms so kind!

10-088-P02 But I know there are some peevish creatures
 Who long since have lost their lovely features

Editorial note. Manuscript page 28 continues 10-087 and leads to 10-089. The unusual phrase “by the forewarning head” is retained as read; its meaning is uncertain. The boasts and imagined courtship behavior are part of a comic speaker’s voice, not established actions by an identified ancestor.

Scan 089 10-089

The camp meeting speaker answers his imagined critics

10-089-P01 29

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Who will censure me quite severely
 For all which I have here said sincerely,
 And will dubiously say “he is a devilish scamp
 And one too of the most outrageous stamp,
 And, the girls should not allow such capers,
 But give him at once his walking papers!”
 Should some thus talk I can only say
 That they have not known in lifes rugged way
 The glorious pleasure, the enraptured bliss
 That hovers around an endearing kiss
 They are such persons as an aged tale avers
 Of winning charms or gentle graces devoid
 Who have so far gone Lifes journey all alone
 To social joys and high vested bliss unknown,
 Who have this *[[Cythera’s?]]* bright congenial shores
 Plucked no fruits from its unrivaled bowers
 But withered them all beneath a misanthropic Sun
 Until their nobler feelings were forever gone
 And now they stand upon Lifes verge
 Whining to Youth and happiness a mournful dirge.

10-089-P02 But when we meet a beauteous girl
 The pride and envy of the world
 Whose matchless beauty and faultless grace
 Displays each lovely feature of form and face
 Where from a high and classic brow
 The raven tresses fall around a neck of snow,
 And from her dark eyes deep lustrous hue
 The beaming soul looks unimprisoned through,

He who can these innumered there uniting art
And not feel the fond effect of Cupids dart—

Editorial note. Manuscript page 29 continues 10-088 and leads to 10-090. The geographic or mythological name before “bright congenial shores” is uncertain; Cythera is a tentative reading only. Several grammatically irregular lines remain as written. The attacks on critics are the speaker’s rhetoric.

Scan 090 10-090

The camp meeting poem concludes with an imagined embrace

10-090-P01 30

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

His soul is dead to all that’s fair and dear
And from the most unpropitious climes not a tear
But will sink into an unhonored tomb
Fit sequel to his life’s deep seated gloom.

10-090-P02 Ah! when I meet *[[deleted: illegible]]* maiden fair
With “azure eyes and golden hair”
With moulded limbs elastic tread
With dimpled cheeks and fairy head,
With sunny smiles and nymphly charms
And noble mien my bosom warms
With all those chaste sweet desires
The wand of Love so oft inspires,
And when her yielding hand I clasp
In affections ardent grasp
And gently draw unto my breast
The object where my fondest feelings rest
And meet the glance of the soul lit eye
And hear the short yet deep heaving sigh
While from a puckered lip all fair
Backward flows her waving hair
And with the sweetish of caress
Her living lips to mine she press
Sending thro’ my deepest soul
Affections springs which spurn control
The wild enchanting raptures tell
Of the wide world exists all in this.
Sept 1866

Editorial note. Manuscript page 30 concludes 10-086–10-089, dated September 1866. Several unusual phrases are retained, including “propitious climes,” “sweetish of caress,” and the final line. A deleted word before “maiden” is illegible. The romantic scene is a poetic description, not evidence of a particular relationship.

Scan 091 10-091

Idle Hours on lost hopes and storms

10-091-P01 31

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Idle Hours.

10-091-P02 I can for hours watch the tempest fly
And listen to the deep mouthed thunder roar
As they roll in grandeur in the sky
Where all was peace and quiet once before.

10-091-P03 And a wild companionship I own
With these fierce scenes of strife,
Now that my serener peace is gone
In the rude blasts of early life.

10-091-P04 Once was my sky bright blue and clear
And every hope of pleasure gave
But now alas! all is dull and drear
And fondest hopes lie withered in the grave.

10-091-P05 What once was spread with fairest flowers
And where sweetest fruit in prospect gleamed
When pleasure winged the golden hours
And light and life and joy all seemed
To be upon my pathway bright spread
With happiness the vision bright
All fraught with bliss before me laid
In one long line of gleaming light.

10-091-P06 I little dreamed of this dark hour
When Peace I'd woo from wildest strife
Or thought I'd subject be to the dark power
Which blasted thus my early life

Editorial note. Manuscript page 31 continues at the top of 10-092, dated Seclusion, August 23, 1866. "What once" and the unusual syntax of the longer stanza are retained. The poem's buried hopes and blighted life are figurative statements, not proof of a named bereavement.

Scan 092 10-092

Idle Hours concluded and memories of an oasis in life

10-092-P01 32

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

But so it is, with callous heart
I face the world nor fear its scorn
Conscious still that I can bear my part
Though deeper in my bosom press the thorn.
Seclusion Aug 23rd 1866

10-092-P02 *[[separate block: a second poem, main text continuing into the lower right margin]]*

While backward gazing through the lapse of years
 A lone oasis in my early life appears
 Beautifully verdured and flowery fair
 And draped in brightness richly rare
 There Sunshine played o'er *[[inserted: each]]* happy scene
 And enchanting beauties shed their silver sheen
 Upon the vernal air, in bright relief
 To Lifes surrounding wastes of gloomy grief.

10-092-P03 Careless I strayed its glorious aisles among
 Where mid embowering sweets still sweeter sung
 Innocent warblers their soul stirring lays
 Adding music's bliss to each unclouding maze—
 Blinded by the beauteous scenes I saw around
 Methought these scenes so bright would always abound
 That downward in Life's meandering march
 Such beauteous bowers would forever arch
 Amid my pathway and lend their brightest hues
 To shed a soft delight and milder joys infuse.

10-092-P04 But soon the glowing pageant *[[inserted: swiftly]]* passed
 And before me lay Lifes dreary waste
 Its scorching sands far spread before the eye
 Where fierce Simoons of Hate hurl them on high
 Burying beneath its fiercely burning sway
 Each nobler passion that might chance to stray
 Oft in the desert heart where once sweetly stood
 All the purer instincts of the generously good,
 But where nought now of pleasures hopes remains
 Except the sad Remembrance—"it can ne'er come again!"
 Jan 14th 1867
 George Douglas

10-092-P05 *[[separate block: separate verse in upper right margin]]*

There is a loneliness of the heart
 No words can e'er express
 Too deep for Sorrows tears to start
 To relieve the aching breast
 A joyless motionless *[[moody?]]* waste
 All dark and drear, forlorn
 And every lovely flower thats placed
 Upon it hides a poisonous thorn.
 G. D.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 32 contains three distinguishable pieces: the conclusion of 10-091, dated August 23, 1866; a new poem continuing into the lower right margin, signed George Douglas and dated January 14, 1867; and a separate eight-line marginal verse signed G. D. The marginal writing was rotated for reading. "Simoons"

denotes the poem's hot desert winds; the metaphors do not establish travel to a desert. The word before "waste" in the short verse remains uncertain.

Scan 093 10-093

The anonymous courtship poem resumes with Seclusion

10-093-P01 33

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Continued from 9th page.

But amid all this confusion

What has become of "Seclusion"?

I saw him on the fourth of July

Slipping about rather sly

Squinting first at this then that one

For the world like a chap undone.

And—list! oh ye many Stars and

I saw him close beside Miss McFarland

And at that time I've "hearn tell"

He was seen to fan Miss Maggie Bell.

10-093-P02 But still I say tis all in vain howies

You may around about you peer

And strive to find out my incog

Safe I fire from behind a log

And hit them all a few times more

Until they fume as neer they fumed before

I care not, let them fret and roar

And use their voices till their throats are sore

The only satisfaction that I have

Is to see my fellow mortals rave.

10-093-P03 But I felt myself vastly flattered

When oer those pages Freely plastered

And pronounced me with decision sage

The greatest poet of the modern age.

10-093-P04 When first I heard this lofty eulogium

Upon my merits—the glorious vision

Of Fame undying—transport elysium

Shot through my heart with unrivalled precision

Editorial note. Manuscript page 33 explicitly continues page 9, which is scan 10-069; the poem runs through 10-096. Here Miss McFarland and Miss Maggie Bell are named, but the men's sobriquets remain unexpanded. "Howies," "incog," and awkward rhymes are retained. The boast about firing from behind a log is a metaphor for anonymous verse, not a report of shooting. The July 4 encounter is a claim in comic verse, not independently corroborated.

Scan 094 10-094

The comic poet's disappointed hopes for Kitty and Laura

10-094-P01 34

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Which made me feel like a modern Pope
And bade me for eternal honors hope.

10-094-P02 But unto you before whom poets bow
With deep heartfelt adoration
Will you listen at me now
While I narrate a sad narration.
This fond heart at last is broken
“Because no one will me love”
Although the words which I have spoken
Were inspired from above.

10-094-P03 Once I thought I would write a ditty
To the handsome pleasant little Kitty
But as the lines I began to trace
There came along one Samuel Pace
And with his earnest gesticulations
Spoilt all my handsome calculations
So I had to seek for a new bower
To try again my magic power
Which by the way is not so magical
As has been fully proved by all.

10-094-P04 Next in my view came Pleasant hill
In all its glory blooming still
And I thought I could neer be dreary
While there smiled a lovely Laura,
So with the best of all my art
I bound up my shattered heart
And dressed it in the gayest smiles
That ever bloomed on earth the while,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 34 continues 10-093 and leads to 10-095. Kitty, Samuel Pace, Laura, and Pleasant hill are named in the verse, but their identities and the literal truth of the romantic competition are not established. “A modern Pope” is a literary allusion in a boast about poetry; no external attribution is asserted.

Scan 095 10-095

Sammy wins Laura in the poem's mock campaign

10-095-P01 35

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

And thought to offer on her altar
A love that would never never falter,

But alas! for all my speculations
How they are spoilt by oppositions.

10-095-P02 For you see at last there came
The backward bashful modest Sam
And urged his suit with so much ardor
That I seriously thought of gunpowder,
But I knew if I wrought his ruin
'Twould be also my own undoin,
So I acted fairly on my part
But Sammy won dear Lauras heart
And left me like a lamb shorn
Out in the cold my loss to mourn.

10-095-P03 Before the Delphine Shrine I could bow
And plead my cause with ardor now
But I have not the will *[[deleted: to charge]]*
To charge against strong Prospect Hill.
Two Generals are entrenched there
Within the hearts of the lovely Fair
And a poor Corporal has no chance
To force them out with spear or lance,
But must at once raise the siege
And seek another nearer leige.

10-095-P04 Go where I will where can I find
One more suited to my mind?
Than you fair maid? whose purest love
Is gently distilled from above

Editorial note. Manuscript page 35 continues 10-094 and leads to 10-096. "Delphine" and "leige" are retained as written. Generals, corporal, gunpowder, and siege belong to the courtship metaphor and do not establish military ranks or a violent incident. The poem claims Sammy won Laura's heart; this is not a marriage record.

Scan 096 10-096

The courtship poem ends with a plea and two epigrams

10-096-P01 36
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
The noble passions that to thy heart is given
Are but affections Strayed from Heaven
And upon natures own bestown that heart of thine
Receives direct a gift divine.
Can it be wrong for me to seek
That love, of which I scarce dare speak?
Oh no! that which is to mortals given
Should be by mortals owned although from Heaven.
July 30th 1866

10-096-P02 *[[separate block: two short verses below]]*

If it be true that all still waters
Indicate a deep hole
I suppose an old maids clatter
Betokens a mighty shoal.

10-096-P03 “Married life is a great source of happiness”

Designing Sapheads conjecture
But they *[[deleted: illegible]]* will change their minds soon I guess
“When they receive a curtain lecture!”

Editorial note. Manuscript page 36 concludes the poem begun at 10-069 and resumed at 10-093–10-095; dated July 30, 1866. The awkward second couplet is retained. Two separate epigrams below mock unmarried women and marriage. A “curtain lecture” is a domestic scolding in the joke, not a documented event. No signature appears here.

Scan 097 10-097

Idle Hours on childhood innocence

10-097-P01 37

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Idle Hours.

10-097-P02 The first the fondest purest hopes
Of Lifes bright sunny hour
Bloom fresh within a narrow scope
Like Springs bright vernal flower.

10-097-P03 Then does the mind expanding glow
Beneath a genial Sun
And joys bright perennial flow
Yet still their source is one.

10-097-P04 That source is guileless innocence
By the infant heart expressed
Breathing a holy sweet incense
Upon its mothers breast.

10-097-P05 And angels hover oer its way
On Spirit wings afar
To turn each else baneful ray
That its purity might mar.

10-097-P06 And weeping oer each wayward thought
That Springs within its mind
Lest all thats lovely comes to nought
Which speaks its will divine,

10-097-P07 But alas! what are Angels tears?
Or what can they avail?
When through the blight of after years
We read the hearts sad tale.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 37 continues at 10-098, dated Seclusion, August 26, 1866. The poem's infant, mother, angels, and later despair are generalized images. No particular child or mother is identified.

Scan 098 10-098

Idle Hours concludes with grief for lost innocence

10-098-P01 38

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Of hopes once bright now faded gone

With happier hours past by

Leaving the heart a hardened stone

With all affections fountains dry.

10-098-P02 And Disappointment too deeply written

Upon Lifes dreary page

And earlier joys forever smitten

And withering in declining age,

10-098-P03 With life a blank, and Sorrow stamped

Upon the wrinkled brow

And Memory embittered damped

With scenes of by gone woe.

10-098-P04 And dark Despair still hovering oer

The shattered wreck of Man

Nor hope can lend upon Times shore

One ray to cheer him on again.

10-098-P05 Then what avail are angels tears

Since we must suffer so

And reap through succeeding years

Succeeding fields of woe?

10-098-P06 Oh! it is best in Childhoods time,

To find an early grave

And return to Heaven undimmed

The jewel which it gave!

Seclusion Aug 26th 1866

Editorial note. Manuscript page 38 concludes 10-097, dated August 26, 1866. The final stanza imagines an early grave as preserving childhood innocence. It is literary and religious reflection, not a death notice or evidence that a particular child died.

Scan 099 10-099

Idle Hours at sunset beside a stream

10-099-P01 39

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Idle Hours,

10-099-P02 The Sun was sinking in the west
 Deep in an azure sky
 Nature slowly retiring to rest
 Hymned its music far on high.
 Forth from a cozy fireside I
 Strayed alone in musing mood
 Down near a Streamlet murmuring by
 A deep and Solitary wood.
 And passions hot my bosom fired
 O'erwing my senses in headlong speed
 Ambition urged to win the admired
 And gain a heart the wished meed,
 A wreath of beauty yet afar
 On lifes uncertain Sea,
 Yet none the less a glorious star
 Tho' veiled in deep uncertainty.

10-099-P03 I tracked upon Lifes future road
 My devious way unto the prize
 Where I could lay my heart felt load
 Of Love before her Soul-lit eyes;

10-099-P04 'Tis sweet to look adown the tide of Time
 And see awaiting glories shine
 'Tis sweet to hear their voices chime
 And fancy their blending beauties mine.
 'Tis sweet to think that I may win
 A heart my weary way to cheer
 Through hours of Darkness intervene—
 A Starless night's monotonously drear,
 Continued on page 52

Editorial note. Manuscript page 39 has a continuation reference read as page 52. The writer imagines winning an unnamed beloved's heart; this is hope, not proof of a relationship. Some grammar is irregular and has not been silently repaired in the reference transcript. The continuation is at 10-112 (manuscript page 52), which explicitly refers back to page 39, and then 10-113.

Scan 100 10-100

An apology to Miss M L G for the anonymous rhymes

10-100-P01 40

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

To Miss M. L. G.....

10-100-P02 Throughout the livelong day amid the crowds
 I patient sat and listened to the thundring words
 Of a long sermon delivered to the sinners
 Who were kept in the heat without their dinners.

10-100-P03 It may be well for Christian folks to fast
But feed the sinners if you would keep them to the last
Lest they become uneasy and run away
And get no Salvation on that day.

10-100-P04 But Saint and Sinner vanished from my mind
And the good preacher with his words so kind
When low amid the crowded clan
Some idle vacant whisperings ran,

10-100-P05 That you were offended like the Nation
At an anonymous Communication
Which had been dished up in rhyme
And forwarded to *[[lifless?]]* rhyme thrice.

10-100-P06 And you thought the author of the rhyming clatter
Had surely overdone the matter
And in his Simple little Song
Had piled it on rather Too Strong.

10-100-P07 I am misfortunes favorite child
For all my noblest hopes are foiled
By my impassioned nature drives
My Sentiment thoughts I fondly pen
So ever tho I Strike on the lyre

Editorial note. Manuscript page 40 continues at 10-101, dated August 15, 1866. The line about forwarding the rhyme contains uncertain or awkward wording. “By my impassioned nature drives” and the final lines are retained despite irregular syntax. This poem refers to the recipient’s reported offense at anonymous verses; it does not establish the identities behind the earlier sobriquets.

Scan 101 10-101

The anonymous poet offers an apology

10-101-P01 41
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
And always overshot the mark,

10-101-P02 I every passion in one effort fling
And aim to reach the goal at one bold Spring
So ever thus my fondest hopes I blast
By being just a little bit too fast.

10-101-P03 I am extremely sorry and would apologize
For having written to you in this wise,
If I knew how—but I cannot claim
The honor of approaching you by name.

10-101-P04 But if I thought I could win your partial favor
I would throw off my disguise and endeavor

To rush to your presence half annihilated by fear
And plead my case like a Lawyer at the bar.

10-101-P05 I would not have any words to retrace
And speak the whole truth in their place
Unless I supply some new compliment
With deeper feelings fully blent.

10-101-P06 I would not hurt your feelings for the world
(Allow me to except one lovely girl).
And would humbly humbly apologize
And hope to read my pardon in your eyes.

10-101-P07 When I write to you again
I will select a nobler Strain
[[*deleted: To descend*]] And invoke the Parnassian Nine
To descend and my vulgar thoughts refine,
Aug 15th /66

Editorial note. Manuscript page 41 concludes 10-100, dated August 15, 1866. "Humbly" is repeated in the source. The parenthetical exception reads "one lovely girl" after enlargement. The poet promises to invoke the Parnassian Nine, a classical reference to the Muses. He does not reveal his name on this page.

Scan 102 10-102

Invocation dedicated to Miss M L Green perhaps

10-102-P01 42
[[*separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form*]]
Respectfully Inscribed to Miss M. L. [[*Green?*]]
Invocation

10-102-P02 Come ye heavenly Sister band
From Parnassus height
Come and with the starry brand
Of Inspiration my pen relight
Come let the thoughts of Heaven refined
Flash through my heart inspire my mind
With all those feelings pure and bright
Which emanate from the source of light.
Let no corruptive thought their powers blend
With these true words I dedicate to a friend
But let the noblest sentiment that ever rose
In the human breast descend from the Stars
Nor lose upon their lengthy flight
The Stamps of Heavens refulgent light
But let them glow transcendently fair
As ever they did within their native Star
Ere baser Passions taught the human heart
To act the lie or show deceptions art.

10-102-P03 Yes, Pure Friendship demands a nobler offering
 Than aught that earthly treasure E'er can bring
 Something pure which flows from heart to heart
 Which wit with all its Schemes cannot impart;
 But bears upon its face the impress of the Soul
 Which friend to friend from time to time may candidly unroll
 And now upon fair Friendships Shrine
 I place this Simple offering of mine,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 42 continues at 10-103, dated Seclusion, August 21, 1866. The dedication appears to give the surname Green, but the letters after the capital are indistinct; it remains a tentative reading. The nearby poems use M. L. G. and may concern the same person, but the full identity is not established. The classical invocation is literary imagery.

Scan 103 10-103

Trust as the strongest bond of friendship

10-103-P01 43

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

'Tis Confidence, the first flower in the wreath of Love
 Which I now bestow a boon drawn from above
 Inspired by Heaven in thy Stainless truth,
 (The noblest gift now owned by mortal youth)
 Accept it, for within it lies
 The strongest links in Friendships holy ties.

10-103-P02 Then will the Social joys live again
 And within our hearts supremely reign
 And base Detraction hurled from his high seat
 Into the dust and trampled 'neath our feet
 Can rise no more in a hideous form
 To shake our trust or mar our joys so warm,
 Joys which will in long succession rise
 And date their birthright from the skies
 And through successive ages roll
 The light of life, the adamant of the soul
 Strengthening through succeeding years
 Erasing darkening doubts, dispelling gloomy fears.

10-103-P03 A Panacea for all human woes
 Which the unwilling future may disclose
 Leaving Nature in its purest mood
 When with pulses high and madly bounding blood
 The human breast by contending passions wildly driven
 Exiles Mercy from its home, defying Heaven
 Heaven with all its deep emotions pure
 Which requires no grosser props our to insure
 Through our downward march to Lifes ending scene

Noble thoughts divine, deep, bright, and serene.
Seclusion August 21st 1866

Editorial note. Manuscript page 43 concludes “Invocation” at 10-102. The date is August 21, 1866. “Which requires no grosser props our to insure” is awkward wording retained as read; the family version gives its apparent general sense without inventing a missing object. “Adamant” is used as a metaphor for something enduring or unyielding.

Scan 104 10-104

Written on the death of Robert D Andrews

10-104-P01 44

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Written on the death of

Robert D. Andrews,

10-104-P02 I stood beside his Soulless clay
And confined breast
And saw the hopes of yesterday
In death’s robe drest.
I heard the solemn service read
The funeral rite
The last tribute to the noble dead
Shrouded in white.

10-104-P03 “Before us lays his mortal form
His Spirit fled
“His voice our hearts no more will warm
For he is dead.
“Though gone and we shall see no more
Him that we love
“Yet One has passed on before
To Heaven above,
“That One has borne the shameful cross
On Calvary,
“He rejects alone the worthless dross
Of mortality,
“The Soul, the Gem, that Heaven gave
So pure and bright
“Shall safely pass beyond the grave
To realms of light.
“Upon its threshold we may meet
To part no more
“And those we’ve loved shall sweetly greet
Us on that Shore,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 44 begins an elegy continued through the upper part of 10-106, where it is signed George Douglas and dated Seclusion, December 24, 1866. The heading names Robert D. Andrews. The poem records a funeral and later calls him a friend and companion of the speaker’s youth; it does not give an age, kinship, burial location, or precise date of death. Quotation marks indicate a passage voiced as a funeral address, not a verified verbatim sermon.

Scan 105 10-105

A friend and companion of the poet's youth

10-105-P01 45

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Slowly the Shroud around him wound

Its spotless folds

Then deep was laid beneath the ground

Affections holds.

Friend and companion of my youth

Though death has come

It could not blast the lovely Truth

That bore thee home.

Though we shall meet no more on earth

Thy memory

In my hours of wildest mirth

Shall sacred be.

“And though I run Lifes mad career

Wild as the wave,”

I'll pause, and drop, fond Friendship's tear,

Upon thy grave.

When Spring in beauty bright shall come

And robe the trees,

The rose shall shed its sweet perfume

Upon the breeze.

The daisy on the verdant lea

Shall sweetly blow

And Natures wildest minstrelsy

Joyously flow.

No more with thee shall these bright scenes

Pass in review

For all that earthly pleasure means

Has passed from you.

No more with thee we'll greet the morn

When carols sweet

On fragrant winds to Heaven are borne

An offering meet

Editorial note. Manuscript page 45 continues the elegy for Robert D. Andrews at 10-104 and leads to 10-106.

“Affections holds” is the awkward phrase as read. The poem explicitly says “Friend and companion of my youth”; it does not say cousin, brother, or another kinship.

Scan 106 10-106

George Douglas's farewell to Andrews and Ad idem

10-106-P01 46

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

To Natures God, who rules above
 In purity
 The Universes, with the Laws of love
 Through eternity.
 With thee no more will we hear
 These raptures rise
 And in their inspiration clear
 Ascend the skies,
 For thou art gone, beyond Death's gloom
 In Heaven to dwell
 And I can but breathe upon thy tomb
 A last farewell.
 Seclusion Dec 24th 1866
 George Douglas

10-106-P02 Ad idem,
 Oh! come with me to a lone graveyard
 Where the oak trees wave their stately boughs
 Where the sunshine on the soft greensward
 And the daisy in its beauty blows.

10-106-P03 Where warbling birds on their brilliant wings
 Hymn their sweetest notes in the forest near—
 Where the heart melted by soft reflection springs
 Heavenward through the deeply sorrowing tear,

10-106-P04 Oh come! and kneel by a fresh made mound
 Where the violet never has bloomed
 Lowly bend over the damp cold ground
 Where the early dead is deeply entombed

Editorial note. Manuscript page 46 concludes 10-104–10-105, signed George Douglas, Seclusion, December 24, 1866. “Ad idem” introduces a separate poem on the same subject, continuing at 10-107. The graveyard is described but not named. “Where the sunshine” is retained without supplying an absent verb.

Scan 107 10-107

Ad idem concludes with Courtesy and truth

10-107-P01 47
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
 Drop here a tear with the broken hearted
 That live to mourn the loved and lost
 And the cherished hopes death has thwarted
 With the blasting blight of its early frost.

10-107-P02 In affection weep! oer Sundered ties
 Woven in lifes bright early may-morn.
 Weep for the one that now lowly lies
 Where the pain racked heart ne'er may mourn.

10-107-P03 His hopes his joys and prospects are past
 Like the dews of the morning swiftly away—
 Too bright was that heart—it could not last
 Through the withering scenes of ensuing day.

10-107-P04 Oh sincerely weep! oer the one that has gone
 For the melting Soul by tears is refined
 And as each pearly drop brightly flows on
 The heart gently expands to receive the divine.

10-107-P05 Oh sincerely weep! for the record on high
 Against the heart by sin earthly defiled
 Is gently removed by the deep heaving sigh
 And wins back the joy—Heaven reconciled.

10-107-P06 Oh sincerely weep! 'tis a tribute but due
 To the associate of our earlier youth
 A noble companion devoted and true
 Whose burning motto was "Courtesy and truth"
 Jany 5th /67
 Geo. D.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 47 concludes the second memorial poem begun at 10-106. Signed Geo. D., dated January 5, 1867. "Courtesy and truth" is presented as the deceased companion's motto in the poem. In context the subject is associated with the preceding Robert D. Andrews elegy, but his name is not repeated here. Religious statements express the poet's belief.

Scan 108 10-108

Varying Moments from delight to darkness

10-108-P01 48
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
 Varying Moments,

10-108-P02 Oh! there are moments when we rove
 Imaginations delights among
 Softly inspired by nobler love
 And rapt in joyous song

10-108-P03 Oh! there are moments, when we give
 Our purest noblest thought
 To the higher aim, for which we live
 The aim for us with blood bought,

10-108-P04 These moments beam with soft delight
 Unknown to darker hours,
 Shedding a bright yet transient light
 O'er this dark way of ours.

10-108-P05 Shadowing forth a happier day
 Of peace and quiet rest!

When in fairer fields we may stray
By flowers and Sunshine blest!

10-108-P06 When the Soul expanding will inhale
The perfume of purer joys
Than those which round us now exhale
From ruder passions gross alloys.

10-108-P07 But soon! oh too soon is past!
These visions of brighter days
And darker moments are gathering fast
Through which no sunbeam strays,

Editorial note. Manuscript page 48 continues at 10-109. The poem contrasts spiritual joy with bitterness and human reasoning. Religious imagery is preserved as the speaker's belief; the line about an aim bought with blood is not a record of a specific injury or battle.

Scan 109 10-109

Varying Moments questions human systems of thought

10-109-P01 49
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
Moments of Bitterness, deep and dark
When wither each holier aim;
Aims that rise as twere Spark by Spark
From a lone and dying flame.

10-109-P02 These bitter moments congeal the Soul
And cramp its warm desires
Yet their way they onward roll
Like fierce consuming fires,

10-109-P03 Fed by man with his isms wild
That rack the brain, the Senses whelm,
Distracting from his way each tender child
That does not know who guides the helm!

10-109-P04 Oh! man, that tryest to lead the way
Through Lifes temptations scenes,
Canst thou, pour into a heavenly ray
And tell us what it means?

10-109-P05 Canst make the darkened Spirit light
Remove each load of care,
And give us hopes forever bright
While we may wander here?

10-109-P06 Do not thy isms blur each page
Of Light that to us is given?
Do not thy isms augment with age
And shut out the light of Heaven?

June 14th /67.

Geo. D.

Editorial note. Manuscript page 49 concludes 10-108, signed Geo. D., June 14, 1867 as read. The repeated word is “isms,” a general attack on human systems or doctrines, not a named creed. “Pour into a heavenly ray” is awkward wording retained in the reference transcript.

Scan 110 10-110

An album as a keepsake of absent friends

10-110-P01 50

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

For an Album,

10-110-P02 When young we treasure up some sacred Ties
Of Lifes bright morn while all is gay
Some garlands gathered ere the dewdrop dries
Of beautys smile, too soon to pass away.

10-110-P03 We twine them in a pure and fragrant wreath
And lay them on the heart in Friendships name
And note how swift the sable wings of death
Sweeps from us those flowers we loved to claim.

10-110-P04 In after days we sadly weep alone
Oer those withered gems of earlier years
Which leads the Memory back to loved ones gone
Who left us to loneliness and tears.

10-110-P05 These treasures are some thoughts to virtue given
And traced upon an Albums spotless page
By Youths careless heart ere by Sorrow driven—
Or claimed by Death for his tutelage.

10-110-P06 So oer this page I now careless strew
Some idle thoughts which may yet recall
Unto thy Memory one you knew
But who ah! too soon perhaps didst fall.

10-110-P07 Perhaps a lone tear from thine eye may start
While thinking on his joyless career
And a deep sigh escape thy tender heart
To mingle with that gently flowing tear.
February 1867

Editorial note. Manuscript page 50, dated February 1867. No author or recipient is named. The closing lines imagine the writer’s future death; they are not evidence that he died then. Grammatical forms such as “didst fall” are retained.

Scan 111 10-111

Farewell to Irene

10-111-P01 51

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Song

Farewell! Irene the parting hour
 Has come, and I must away
 But back to you my cherished flower
 Memory will love to stray.
 Broken hopes around me lying
 Speak of brighter scenes now gone
 And brighter prospects slowly dying
 Warn of sadness coming on.

10-111-P02 Farewell Irene! we may never
 Meet while we live above
 But oh! Times scythe cannot sever
 From my heart the one I love!

10-111-P03 Oh! I regret to leave you Irene
 And sunder every sacred tie
 That has twined like the ivy green
 Where the charms of virtue lie
 But pleasant hopes do not abound
 But to die mid scenes of Strife
 And Fate between has darkly frowned
 Blighting all my early life.

10-111-P04 Alone I'll wander oer the earth
 Far from scenes I've loved too well
 In pleasures throng I'll seek for mirth
 To check sorrows rising swell.
 Scenes of the past! Oh fade away
 And new hopes my bosom charm
 Careless onward let me reckless stray
 Heeding nought that breathes of harm.
 Feby 1867

Editorial note. Manuscript page 51, dated February 1867, titled Song. Irene is explicitly named, but no surname, signature, tune, or proof of a real relationship is supplied. "While we live above" is retained, even though its sense is unusual. This may be original or copied verse; attribution beyond the manuscript is not established.

Scan 112 10-112

Idle Hours continued in imagination's fields

10-112-P01 52

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

Continued from page 39

'Tis Sweet to rove in fancys fields
 Amid her beauteous flowers
 Where glowing thought rich treasure yields
 In brightness thro successive hours,
 'Tis sweet to hold communion fond
 With nature wild and free
 And feel the magic influence of her wand—
 Imaginations boundless Ideality.

10-112-P02 Oh Imagination! parent of my sweetest joys
 I yield to thee, the homage of the heart,
 Your brightest visions no corruption cloy
 With guileful stains of *[[inserted: dark]]* Reality's art,
 You lead me far amid gayest fields
 Where perennial Summers brightly beam
 You to my heart the sweetest blisses yield
 That in tasting more—still sweeter seem.

10-112-P03 Oh! patron goddess of my happier hours!
 With thee I fondly love to stray
 For thou is spread the fairest sweetest flowers
 Upon my thorn hedged meandering way!
 My visions in sweetest odours drest
 Leap forward on sunny landscapes fair
 That with beautys brightest smiles are blest
 And loveliness exquisitely rare,
 The cankering Cares of Fact vanish
 Before thy approaching lovely face
 Back to oblivion, their hideous forms, you banish
 And to unstained Joys give a glowing place
 Welcome then! hand in hand we'll wander
 Adown the warping Stream of Time

Editorial note. Manuscript page 52 explicitly continues page 39 (10-099) and leads to 10-113. The unusual forms “thou is spread” and “warping Stream” are retained. The insertion “dark” is visible above the line about Reality. The goddess is a personification of imagination, not an identified woman.

Scan 113 10-113

Idle Hours concluded and a later satire

10-113-P01 53

[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]

And gather as we go from each meander
 Its sweetest joys to mingle in our rhyme,
 Jan. 5th /67
 Geo. D.

10-113-P02 *[[separate block: later satirical verse]]*

Alas! My old flame has faded

The bloom from her cheek is now gone
 And her classic brow is now shaded
 By tresses of Beauty=nary one=
 And dull and lifeless is her tread
 As she slowly pines her old maids bed.

10-113-P03 The light from her eye has departed
 Like the gleam of a star in a fog
 And instead of poetically sighing brokenhearted
 She simply grunts like a hog,
 The music of her voice has long gone by
 And no more can she heave affections sigh.

10-113-P04 Calmly she marches on lifes way
 With her old man by her side
 And she has at times a good deal to say
 To make the old fellow provide
 For herself and the young little graces
 Now coming around with surly faces.
 May 1869

Editorial note. The first two lines complete Idle Hours, read 10-099, 10-112, 10-113; they are signed Geo. D., January 5, 1867. A distinct, unsigned satirical poem follows, dated May 1869. Its insults and references to an old maid, an old man and children do not establish anyone's marriage or family. The apparent contradiction is retained.

Scan 114 10-114

Farewell to earthly joys, addressed to Miss M. A. A.

10-114-P01 54
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
 Respectfully Inscribed to Miss M-A-A.
 Farewell! ye joys of earth farewell
 Upon lifes threshold we must part
 I would not try again your syren spell
 I would not risk a broken heart.

10-114-P02 Farewell ye joys! a long farewell!
 No pleasures now I claim
 I've learned your fleeting *[[age?]]* too well
 I've learned ye live but in the name.

10-114-P03 Farewell! with sadness still I speak the word
 Your visions lured me on too far.
 Yet still they tremble oer Memorys Chord
 And softly start the glistening tear.

10-114-P04 Farewell! tis wrong to mourn the decay
 Of visions false yet bright
 Yet without you Lifes dark way
 Is but a weary, weary night.

10-114-P05 But shall I woo bright Fancys gleam
 My darksome way to light?
 Which sparkles like a meteor beam
 Amid the darkness of the night.

10-114-P06 And shines resplendent from afar
 A beacon reared on high
 Like the glorious Morning Star
 Beaming from an early sky

Editorial note. Manuscript page 54 continues at 10-115. The recipient is given only by initials; no surname is expanded. One faded word in the second stanza is tentative. The poem's despair is a literary expression, not proof of a particular broken engagement.

Scan 115 10-115

Imagination offers relief from sorrow

10-115-P01 55
[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]
 Yes I may woo that beauteous ray
 And court its brightness for awhile
 To shine upon my lone dark way
 With its bright illusive smile

10-115-P02 For while that beam resplendent shines
 My soul leaps forth along its trace
 And thought swift treads those burning lines
 Across the trackless realms of Space

10-115-P03 Then! then ye Visions! then your power
 My spirit captive leads
 Then your bright illusions rule the hour
 And my breaking heart no longer bleeds

10-115-P04 I catch bright Fancys glorious ray
 That sheds those dreams of wild delight
 And for awhile my darksome way
 Shines fair in bright effulgent light

10-115-P05 Then flowerets yield their sweet perfumes
 From myriads of ambrosial bowers
 And Pleasures wand with hope illumines
 Each *[[illegible]]* moment of the golden hours

10-115-P06 And aromatic breezes *[[illegible]]* rove
 These ideal fields among
 And bears from out each sainted grove
 Its spicy fragrance swift along.

Editorial note. Continues 10-114. Two short faded passages remain unread. The following scan starts Visit to Siloam, a different poem; a further continuation of the present poem should not be assumed from physical adjacency alone.

Scan 116 10-116

Visit to Siloam

10-116-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Visit To Siloam.

10-116-P02 Twas on the first of Brumaire,
 (I like to be particular as to time
 So no matter when I go or where
 I will always know the occasion of my rhyme.)
 Twas on the first of Brumaire
 As I was just going to say
 That I brushed my shoes and sleeked my hair
 And promised myself a happy day.
 A western wind blew fresh and fair
 The morning clouds soon dispelled
 And as I faced the bracing air
 Its wild free spirit I inhaled.

10-116-P03 I mounted on a trotting horse
 And through the mud swiftly sped
 Unto Siloam I bent my course
 With poesy running in my head,
 Upon its grounds at length arrived
 And tied my steed unto a tree
 Then looked around at how things were contrived
 And to see such things as were to see.
 My heart beat high with hope elate
 While every thing propitious smiled
 With satisfaction I scanned my fate
 And with Hope the sunny hours beguiled.
 While stumping round through its verdant shades
 Oer heaps of logs and now and then a slab
 I came upon some of my old comrades
 Privately enjoying a lone confab.

Editorial note. Continues at 10-117. "Brumaire" is the word written, not silently converted to a modern date. The precise location of Siloam is not established here. The poem describes a social outing and should not be treated as a verified itinerary.

Scan 117 10-117

Siloam companions and courtship banter

10-117-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

"What ho! my comrades are ye here?
 "I give you a cordial greeting
 "But I dont see how you could stir
 "So far from home just for a meeting.

“I’m rather inclined unto the notion
 “That there is some prime moving cause
 “And that you feel some kind of emotion
 “Set in full blast by Cupids laws?

10-117-P02 Slowly at length spoke Prospect Hill

“You are right about the emotion
 “And you may have it by whose laws you will
 “To us works out no ‘motion’
 “I’m told the virgins of our Shrine
 “To day are coming to Siloam
 “One Sylph-like girl I’ll claim as mine
 “And with the rest you may freely roam.

10-117-P03 As thus he spoke I keenly watched
 Each varying emotion on their faces
 That wrinkled up like a stick notched
 In some half a dozen places.

10-117-P04 Then Prospect Junior smilingly replied

“To all I came here at Siloam
 “To rein up to the grey pony’s side
 “And quietly escort him home.

10-117-P05 Thus I to him, “may you no ill betide

“I would not do it for money
 “For you will be sure to ride
 “Home with a Parsons Honey.

Editorial note. Continues 10-116. Prospect Hill and Prospect Junior appear as literary names or nicknames, not identified persons. Some quotation marks are opened on successive lines without closing marks; their form is retained. “To all I came here at Siloam” is awkward but retained. The next scan opens mid-thought; continuity across the transition is not established.

Scan 118 10-118

Sorrow over interrupted social pleasures, and Love

10-118-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Yet no pen can describe the depth of our wo
 Since from the regions of darkness that curtain has strayed.

10-118-P02 “Oh! Euroclydon of Sorrow! that has spread oer our sky,
 May the Sunshine of! softness dispel thy dark gloom.
 That we may gaze once more far upon high,
 To where our bright stars the social Heavens illumine;

10-118-P03 “Then will be restored all the bliss we desire
 Permission to yield our devotion again
 On the Shrine that we love, we can ask no higher
 Enjoyment than this in this low world of pain.

10-118-P04 “Flow on ye bright waters no more will I sing
 To thy limpid clearness the tale of our woes
 Perhaps future years brighter hours may bring
 And in Pleasures lap we may (?) sweetly repose.

Geo. D.

Seclusion Nov 4th 1866

10-118-P05 *[[separate block: short poem]]*

“Love” is a fragrant flowering bud
 That for awhile delights the young
 They gaze upon its rosy blush
 While pulse is high and pleasure strong.
 But its glowing beauties please not long
 Their eyes soon turn to solid charms
 The fickle Goddess breathes a parting song
 And dies within pure friendships arms.

Dec 1866

Geo. D.

Editorial note. The first poem begins mid-thought and is signed Geo. D., Seclusion, November 4, 1866. Its social imagery may connect with Visit to Siloam (10-116–117), but intervening wording has not been securely located. “May the Sunshine of! softness” is retained as written; the source’s parenthesized question mark after “may” is original, not an editorial uncertainty. A separate verse on love and friendship is signed Geo. D., December 1866. Euroclydon is used as storm imagery, not an account of an actual storm.

Scan 119 10-119

To Miss Mat. A. on truth and affection

10-119-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

To Miss Mat. A.

As o’er that brow so pensive calm pure
 I fondly gaze with ardor beaming eye
 I read with Prophetic inspiration clear
 Some pure lineaments strayed from Paradise.

10-119-P02 And lighted on this stormy world below
 Still blooming fair in firmest purity
 The loveliest gift Heaven *[[deleted: could]]* could e’er bestow
 From the vast bounds of its immensity.

10-119-P03 That gift is Truth, the donor Heaven
 And you fair girl the recipient are
 Of the noblest boon to mortal given
 Which e’er inhabited this lowly sphere.

July 1866

Geo. D.

10-119-P04 Ad idem

The remembrance of when last we met
 Still fills my heart with pleasure.

And I never never shall forget
You who are my only Treasure.

10-119-P05 The emotions then that thrilled my breast
Holy and pure—yet unspoken
Are burning yet and will not rest
Forming links ne'er to be broken.

10-119-P06 Links of affection pure unstained,
By deep Designs dark alloy
Pure as e'er has been attained
Pure as the purest earthly joy.

Editorial note. The first poem is addressed to Miss Mat. A. and signed Geo. D., July 1866. "Ad idem" introduces another poem to the same subject, continued at 10-120. The initials and shortened name are not expanded; a real courtship or engagement is not established. The overwritten first occurrence of "could" is treated as canceled.

Scan 120 10-120

Enduring affection and two irreverent epitaphs

10-120-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Oh! maiden fair, you know not the tie
That round my heart is hourly twining
You knownot the feelings which burie lie
For Loves rolls deep divining.

10-120-P02 Feelings which will linger long
When Youthful bloom has faded
Glowing still bright and strong
Tho' by Age darkly shaded.
December 1866.
Geo. D.

10-120-P03 Epitaph,
Draw near and drop a pious tear
Beside this monumental stone
For the bones which now moulder here
Were once a mighty living Bore.

10-120-P04 Epigram.
Oh! what a pity! man should waste
So much good time upon a stone
Simply at last to have it placed
Above a foully rotten Bone!

Editorial note. The first two stanzas complete Ad idem at 10-119, signed Geo. D., December 1866. The irregular wording "burie lie / For Loves rolls deep divining" is retained; its exact sense is uncertain. Two distinct short satires follow. Neither identifies a deceased person or grave.

Scan 121 10-121

Hours of Bitterness: remembered pleasures

10-121-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Hours of Bitterness.

Oh there are moments when the past

Comes oer me as a dream

The scenes of youth—too bright to last

That shed *[[illegible]]* a flickering gleam,

Of happiness o'er my saddened heart

Where not a ray of light now strays

That could a moments bliss impart

But what would ere the instant fade.

I've grasped at Pleasures lively host

That in swift groups swept by

I've mingled in its wildest boast

With pulses madly bounding high;

I've seen its charms before me spread

In bright succession far

I've felt its influence when it led

My way from Star to Star,

Of Beauty that so brightly reigned

Queen of every idle heart

That blindly knelt in her bright train

The centre of gay folly's mart.

I've seen the smiles of eager joy

Play on the rosy lips

Unstained by Arts deep dark alloy

That Hope's sweet fountains sips.

I've seen the fondly loving eyes

Meet eyes that loved again

I've heard the softest earliest sigh

Of the heart by Cupid slain.

I've felt the hopes which fire the blood

When prospective joys appeared,

Editorial note. Begins a long poem continued through 10-128; read in consecutive scan order, rotating 10-123. The present page is undated and unsigned. A faded portion of the fourth verse line remains unread. "But what would ere the instant fade" and "wildest boast" are retained as read.

Scan 122 10-122

Hours of Bitterness: hopes that vanish

10-122-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

I've felt the influence of a gayer mood

When songs of revelry were heard.

But what were they, a moment bright

A minute like a flickering spark
That upward leaps from a lone light
Then dies and leaves all doubly dark.

10-122-P02 I've seen the hopes of Life decay
Ere morning dews were dried
I've felt my joys low with'ring lay
Like garlands in the desert wide;
All I have loved with trusting heart
All I have hoped in early days.
I've seen before me fast depart
Like dews in mornings gaze.
I've tried to win those pearly dews
To keep within my heart
I've hoped a gentler spirit to infuse
With their pure and guileless art.
I've tried to gather *[[deleted: sweetest]]* fragrant flowers
That bloomed my way along
To intertwine with happier hours
And interweave in joyous song.
Before my touch those dew drops bright
Fled like morning mists away
When the suns bold beaming light
Proclaimed the Advent of the day.
Those fragrant flowers of loveliness
Like Snowflakes on the sea
Reclined an instant on my breast
Then swelled its storminess.

Editorial note. Continues 10-121 and leads to 10-123, which is inverted in the PDF. The canceled word before "fragrant" is retained as an editorial deletion. The closing metaphor is "Then swelled its storminess," not an assertion about an actual sea voyage.

Scan 123 10-123

Hours of Bitterness: loneliness and lost hopes

10-123-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form; page read after 180-degree rotation]]*
Where e'er I turn for solid charms
Where e'er I look with brighter hopes
There is nothing which my bosom warms
Or my hearts deep fountain opes.
I've tried in vain from Purity
To win her gems of priceless worth
To wrench them from Adversity
To illume my way on earth,
Deeper in the dark recess
Of the Souls night I've plunged my way
And only found that nothingness

Within its dreary portals lay.
 A chaotic void filled with gloom
 And stormy passions darkly driven
 Where light and beauty ne'er can come
 Or stray a single breath of Heaven.

10-123-P02 Oh! the dark thoughts which rack the mind
 When lowering hours of loneliness
 Around me hover, and leave behind
 Emotions I can ne'er express.
 Scenes and early visions bright
 Fade like morning dew away
 Hopes which shed a holy light
 Akin to Heavens benignant ray
 Perish too, amid the wreck
 Of Human aims, which "dying fall"
 Nor in descending meet a check
 To save from total ruin all—
 I've turned and wept to see them go
 And leave my heart all desolate.

Editorial note. The scan is inverted; transcription follows a 180-degree rotation. Continues 10-122 and leads to 10-124. The quotation marks around "dying fall" occur in the manuscript; no external literary attribution is established here.

Scan 124 10-124

Hours of Bitterness asks where relief can be found

10-124-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*
 I would recall them now—but Oh!
 'Tis the relentless hand of Fate,
 And who can change its stern decrees?
 When once the signet ring is set?
 We must submit though *[[deleted: 'tis desperate]]* *[[inserted: robbed of ease]]*
 And learn to suffer sorrow yet.

10-124-P02 When will the cup of Wo be full?
 When will the Demon Misery rest?
 When will Dejection cease to pull
 Contentment from the wearied breast?
 When will Oblivions gloomy shades
 Wrap the Past in endless night?
 When will the blackened fiends of Hades
 Cease to lower the Spirits light?
 Are there no hours we may expect
 To bring Sunshine and bright relief?
 Are there no guides that can direct
 A heart from the perennial grief

Of dying Hopes? ere Life begins
 To be an earnest here on earth
 Before the Spirit halfway wins
 The form of that which gave it birth?
 Are there no scenes that may bloom
 Towards Life's dismal closing days
 That will shed a rich perfume
 Of sweetness in its dying maze?
 Are there no joys which swell the breast
 Some purer hours unto us given
 Before we find the final rest
 Prepared for *[[deleted: us]]* *[[inserted: some]]* in Heaven?
 It seems as though all Earth were dark
 And we blind wanderers below

Editorial note. Continues 10-123 and leads directly to 10-125. Two revisions are visible: “robbed of ease” replaces canceled wording, and “some” replaces “us” in the line about heaven. The latter change matters to the poem’s subsequent discussion of competing salvation doctrines. The canceled phrase in the first revision is read as “’tis desperate.”

Scan 125 10-125

Hours of Bitterness: a voice promises rest

10-125-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Travelling—Where? without a mark
 By which we might surely go—
 Travelling in thro’ doubt and gloom
 Thro’ cankering cares on every side
 Behind, before, contentions loom
 And darkly rolls their murky tide;
 In vain for peace and sweet repose
 We gaze around with eager eyes
 And hope amid surrounding woes
 To see a ray of pleasure rise—
 Each distant scene which promise gives
 Of happiness in future days
 Alone in Fancy faintly lives
 And passes as the Summer haze;
 A moment bright it shines afar
 With varied brilliancy on high
 Glowing as a meteor star
 Amid the blackness of the sky
 And as quickly too it expires
 Amid the stillness of the night
 And backward hope as swift retires
 As it advanced to meet the light.
 Oh! even thus we hourly stand

Twixt hope and fear, twixt joy and pain.
 Oft as we feel the heart expand
 As oft we feel it contract again!—
 Hark! a strange sound arrests the ear
 Borne on the swiftly passing gale.
 Hark! it rings again loud and clear
 And faintly echoes down the vale!
 “Lo! here is rest”, it is a voice
 Breaks on the stillness of the gloom,

Editorial note. Continues 10-124 and leads to 10-126. The following pages introduce different quoted voices making competing religious claims. These should not all be attributed as the writer’s own beliefs.

Scan 126 10-126

Hours of Bitterness: competing promises of salvation

10-126-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

“Lo! here is rest!” Oh! man rejoice
 “And to the living fountain come,
 “Here is a balm for every wound
 “Which mortal bosoms deeply bear.
 “By Faith alone it may be found
 “Alone secured by humble prayer,
 “Know of yourselves ye are undone
 “And totally depraved on earth
 “Of redeeming powers you have none
 “Until you taste the second birth;
 “But when you’ve passed from Natures night
 “Wherein ye hourly doubting stand
 “Into the marvellous Spirits light
 “That leads unto a better land,
 “Then Heaven’s glories are thine own
 “In all their spotless purity
 “And before the great Eternal Throne
 “You will rejoice thro’ eternity.
 “This is the way and this alone
 “All others lead to gloom beneath
 “Accept it now the precious boon
 “Before you taste the second death!

10-126-P02 “Lo! here is rest!” again we hear
 From another side the syren tone
 In melodious sweetness it greets the ear
 With a softer cadence before unknown,
 “Lo! here is rest for you oh man
 “Redemption free is shed abroad
 “Come and take ye glorious stand

“Cast aside your sinful load
 “Believe that One has borne a Cross

Editorial note. Continues 10-125 and leads to 10-127. Quotation marks distinguish successive doctrinal voices. The first asserts salvation by faith alone; a second voice begins near the foot of the page. Denominational identities are not supplied by the manuscript and are not assigned here.

Scan 127 10-127

Hours of Bitterness: obedience and predestination

10-127-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

“Up Calvarys rugged steep
 “To free mankind from sins dark dross
 “Believe Oh man! believe and weep
 “And weeping bow at his behest
 “Beneath the flowing crystal tide
 “Then rise in robes of Life be drest
 “For this the mighty Saviour died.
 “On high he stands to plead the cause
 “Of such as may his favor claim
 “By willing obedience to his laws—
 “In seeking for “another name”
 “This way alone can rest be found.
 “For the hungry many waiting Soul
 “False Teachers will always abound
 “While Time its Tide may darkly roll.

10-127-P02 Again we hear a stranger tone
 Ringing thro’ the murky air
 “Know ye oh! man, first last alone
 “What heaven has promised to you here,
 “Predefined from the earliest hour
 “In which Creation had its birth
 “Some were to rise in Spiritual power
 “And be the elect of Heaven on earth,
 “Saved by the great Sacrifice
 “They have no need dark sin to fear
 “For by it Heavens Paradise
 “Is theirs beyond this world of care
 “But some thro’ the endless Night
 “Of misery and dark despair
 “Shut out from Redemption’s light
 “The curse of Heaven must bear,

Editorial note. Continues 10-126 and leads to 10-128. One voice describes belief and immersion; a new voice asserts election and exclusion from redemption. “Predefined” and the awkward “For the hungry many waiting Soul” are retained. These quoted claims are subsequently challenged in the poem.

Scan 128 10-128

Hours of Bitterness rejects contradictory sectarian claims

10-128-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

“For them no sacrifice was made
 “By Heaven’s own Eternal grace,
 “But *[[inserted: they]]* must bear the curse that’s laid
 “On Adam’s fallen erring race,
 “’Tis all in vain they plead for life
 “And happiness beyond the tomb
 “If they are predestined for strife
 “And mis’ry in the world to come.
 “Oh! thus ’tis said—and thus ’twill be
 “As sure as Heaven rules on high
 “This is the law laid down—and ye
 “Must accept it—nor ask why.

10-128-P02 Where shall we go—whom shall we hear
 Whom believe and trust in all?
 Each offers rest from every fear
 Each says the other sure must fall.
 Where is one ray of light that shed
 Amid surrounding darkness drear,
 But what another cloaks in dread
 Each glowing scene it makes appear?

10-128-P03 “We’ll let them go—they all are wrong
 All narrowminded, partial, blind.
 Their brightest Creeds—are an old Song
 In Sectarianism deep refined.
 We’ll let them go—their Sophistry
 Serves but to lead the mind astray
 And to all but Hypocrisy
 They are false—false every way.”
 February 1867

Editorial note. Concludes Hours of Bitterness (10-121–128), dated February 1867, without a signature on this page. The final quotation rejects the conflicting teachers and their sectarian creeds. This is a critique of those claims, not sufficient evidence by itself that the author rejected all religious belief. Horizontal separators in the manuscript distinguish the three movements reproduced as paragraphs.

Scan 129 10-129

Blue eyes imagined during a storm

10-129-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

[[Blue Eyes?]] *[[illegible]]*

10-129-P02 The blustering rain loudly rattles on the roof
 Around the gables sadly sighs the wind

And as I gaze into the fast thickening woof
Of darkness far without all grows dark within.

10-129-P03 Then I turn me to Imagery's fair skies
Where not a cloudlet dims the azure scene
Where far stretched before my raptured vision lies
Wreaths of Beauty shedding o'er all a lovely Sheen.

10-129-P04 And in my fancied visions oft I meet
The angelic gaze of eyes of heavenly blue
With wildest transports their sweet glances I greet,
A holy rapture which pervades my being through.

10-129-P05 Affection's purest strongest flame is kindling then
Flowing in a tide of purest holiest Love
And in fancy's visions oft again and again
I clasp unto my heart this Angel from above.

10-129-P06 Aye! aye! I love that pure and spotless form
For that blue eye in which the deep Soul loves to dwell
They are the gates through which the heart pure and warm
With ebb and flow betrays affections deepest swell.

10-129-P07 Oh! yes I love that noble generous nature which
Betrays itself in those eyes of heavenly blue
Though placed forever beyond my farthest reach
In Fancy's fairest fields, that Spirit I may woo.
February 1867

Editorial note. The heading is badly faded: "Blue Eyes" is tentative and remaining title wording unread. Dated February 1867, with no visible signature or named recipient. The poem explicitly locates the encounter in imagination; it does not identify a partner or establish a relationship.

Scan 130 10-130

Oh! Let Me Forget: childhood and vanished hopes

10-130-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*
Oh! let me forget! In answer to—"Forget; Oh! never!"

10-130-P02 Oh! let me forget the *[[inserted: early]]* scenes of my childhood
When careless I strayed brightest flowers among
On the hills, in the valleys, by the stream in the wildwood,
Inhaling their fragrance all the day long
When my young heart expanded in the bright sunshine
That fed the sweet flowers budding around
And inhaled the pure emotions of the noble and divine
Which haunted the ear at each joyous heart bound.
Oh! let me forget!

10-130-P03 For those scenes in their brightness in Memory lingers
Contrasting so vividly with with the dark gloom around

Like the voices of Some distant melodious singers
 Which reaches us at times with a heavenly sound
 Which partakes not of earth in its mellowing sweetness
 But seems to proceed from a holier Sphere
 And with the rich bursts of its metrical sweetness
 Shows us the discords we always have here.
 Oh! let me forget!

10-130-P04 Oh! let me forget the hopes I have cherished
 In boyhoods bright morn, when all was so fair
 Ah! little I then thought they all would have perished
 And melted away like the mirage in air.
 But they have gone and all that was blooming
 Has rapidly faded before my eager gaze
 Which once was so brightly and sweetly illuming
 My varied wanderings in Lifes dreary maze
 Oh! let me forget!

Editorial note. Continues at 10-131–132, where it is dated February 1867. The title explicitly answers “Forget; Oh! never!” but no author of that earlier piece is given. Repeated “with with” and other grammatical irregularities are retained. The poem is unsigned on these pages.

Scan 131 10-131

Oh! Let Me Forget: leaving home and the horrors of war

10-131-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*

Oh! let me forget the sad tears when I parted
 From home and its charms which I loved so well
 And the fond friends whom I left there broken-hearted
 When I spoke as I thought my last sad farewell.
 To go to that war whose Tocsin was ringing
 The death knell to thousands in our lovely land
 And from its distant bounds was rapidly bringing
 Those daring heroes the shock to withstand.
 Oh! let me forget

10-131-P02 Oh! let me forget the muskets horrid rattle
 Where brothers *[[inserted: contending]]* against brothers fell
 And the cannon’s loud roar in the din of the battle
 Portraying on earth a miniature hell.
 Where Death proudly riding rode on the breeze
 And fiendishly hurled his darts In the plain
 Or where the dark waves of the deep heaving Seas
 Her fiercely cast them again and again.
 Oh! let me forget

10-131-P03 Oh! let me forget those dark scenes of horror
 Which harrowed the soul with visions of dread
 And darkly foreboded that each coming morrow

Would add a new list to the nations of dead,
 And the dark robe of crime gathering o'er us
 Racked the sad heart where the gospel light shone
 And with the prospect of oppression ever before us
 Prepared us to yield ere life was all gone.
 Oh! let me forget!

10-131-P04 Oh! let me forget the maid to whom I plighted
 The wild romantic feelings which burned in my breast
 And those heavenly ties which hourly invited

Editorial note. Continues 10-130 and leads to 10-132. The war is not named, nor are battles, dates of service or the woman in the final stanza. In the collection's context the Civil War is a plausible referent, but this unsigned literary passage alone does not document a particular combat experience. "Her fiercely cast them" is retained as read, with uncertain syntax; the family version gives its apparent sense.

Scan 132 10-132

Oh! Let Me Forget ends with grief and memory

10-132-P01 *[[separate block: reused printed descriptive-roll form]]*
 My wild erring Spirit to sweet moments of rest
 For the charms which encircled her, brought pain at the parting
 And saddens the long hours through each returning day
 And too often 'neath my eyelids the pearly tear starting
 Stains with effeminacy manhood's stern way.
 Oh! let me forget!

10-132-P02 Oh! let me forget the varied Past and its pleasures
 Which never, never again in life can return
 With its hopes and its joys, and the hearts deepest treasures
 Which all moulder now in the Sepulchres urn.
 Like the Storm shivered tree alone on the heath
 Far from its mates in the forests so fair
 I stand and view my branches low scattered in death
 And pour my lament on the wild desert air.
 Oh! let me forget!
 February 1867.

Editorial note. Concludes 10-130–132, dated February 1867. The gendered judgment in "Stains with effeminacy manhood's stern way" belongs to the text and is preserved, not endorsed. The sepulchral and shattered-tree imagery does not by itself establish the death of the unnamed beloved or particular relatives.

Scan 133 10-133

A portrait in verse, dated May 31, 1861

10-133-P01 She was not very beautiful if it be beauties test
 To *[[deleted: with]]* a Clasic model when perfectly at rest;
 And She did not look bewitchingly if witchery it be
 To have a forehead and a lip Transparent as the sea.
 The fashion of her gracefulness was not a followed rule

And her *[[effervescent?]]* sprightliness was never learnt at School
 And her words were all peculiar like the faeries *[[inserted: fabled]]* dialect,
 And her tone was ever Sweetest midst the cadences of grief.
 Said I she was not beautiful? Her eye upon your sight
 Broke with with the lambent purity of planetary light;
 And an intellectual beauty like a light within a vase,
 Touched every line with *[[deleted: beauty]]* *[[inserted: glory]]* of her animated face.
 Written May 31st. 1861 By *[[Lizzie?]]* Douglas

Editorial note. The separate sheet is sideways in the PDF and is read after clockwise rotation. The name after “By” is tentatively Lizzie Douglas, not assigned to George Douglas. “Written” may refer to copying rather than composition; original authorship has not been verified. An apparent canceled “with,” a correction within “effervescent,” the inserted “fabled,” and the substitution of “glory” for “beauty” are preserved. The irregular line “To a Clasic model” and repeated “with with” are retained. The woman described is unnamed.